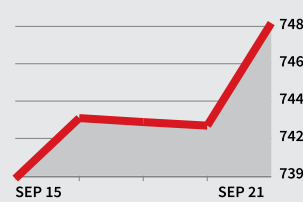


SENSEX 74858.99 (+564.03)



IN FOCUS

	LATEST	CHANGE
Nifty 50	23414.30	+67.90
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	19.87	+0.19
US Dollar (in ₹)	95.81	-0.06
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	152723.00	-388
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	234992.00	-1916

CREATIVE EDGE.

IBM India plans deeper urban expansion on stronger innovation opportunities, says Sandip Patel, MD, IBM India & South Asia **p9**



FRESH BETS.

Catamaran sharpening its focus on growth-stage manufacturing and supply-chain businesses **p8**

QUICKLY.

NEW LAW

India to study US tariff over Russian energy buy



New Delhi: India will study the details emerging after US President Donald Trump signed a law giving him the authority to impose tariffs of up to 100 per cent on major buyers of Russian energy, including India, Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal said. “The details are now emerging. We will study them and discuss the matter at an appropriate time,” Goyal said on Monday. **p7**

TECH SUPPORT HUB

Starbucks to set up first India GCC in Chennai

Chennai: US-based Fortune 500 company and coffee chain Starbucks has signed an MoU with the Tamil Nadu government to set up a global capability centre in Chennai. This company's first GCC in India will support its tech centres in Seattle and Nashville. The Chennai unit will provide 800 “high-paying” jobs to technology professionals, a government statement said. **p2**

New Zealand FTA to give Indian goods nil duty access from Oct 20

TRADE BOOST. Pact vital due to geopolitical uncertainties, unpredictable US tariff policy

Amit Sen

New Delhi

The India-New Zealand FTA will come into force on October 20, allowing duty-free exports of 100 per cent of Indian goods, including labour-intensive products such as textiles, carpets, chemicals, gems and jewellery, pharmaceuticals, automobiles, auto components and machinery.

The pact has the potential to double bilateral trade in goods and services to ₹35,000 crore (about \$4 billion) in four-five years, Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal said.

“New Zealand has furthermore committed to investing \$20 billion in India as foreign direct investment (FDI) under the FTA. This will provide our manufacturing sectors with both capital and technology, while also attracting New Zealand companies to invest in India,” Goyal said at a media briefing on Monday.

WIDER MARKET ACCESS

The agreement, signed on April 27, assumes significant

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- On day 1, 57% of New Zealand exports, including sheep meat, wool, wood products and coal, will be completely tariff-free
- Bilateral trade in goods and services could double to ₹35,000 crore (about \$4 billion) in 4-5 years
- New Zealand has committed \$20 billion in FDI
- India has protected sensitive sectors such as dairy, and key commodities, including onion, chickpea, maize, almond and sugar
- Indian services get access to 118 sectors, plus 5,000 skilled-worker visas a year



ance amid heightened geopolitical uncertainty and US President Donald Trump's unpredictable tariff policy, as New Delhi seeks to diversify its trade partnerships and expand market access for Indian exporters.

For New Zealand, up to 95 per cent of its exports to India, including apples, kiwis, wool and sheep meat, will get greater market access. On the first day of implementation, 57 per cent of New Zealand exports, including sheep meat, wool, several wood

products and coal, will become completely tariff-free, with the share eventually rising to 82 per cent.

For India's services sector, the pact opens access to New Zealand across around 118 sectors, including IT, professional services, construction, tourism and audio-visual services, according to a government statement.

It also provides mobility opportunities through 5,000 skilled-worker visas and 1,000 working-holiday visas annually, along with post-

study work rights of up to four years for Indian students.

SENSITIVE SECTORS

Goyal said the removal of tariffs, which were as high as 10 per cent for some products, would eliminate the disadvantage faced by Indian exporters against countries that already had a foothold in the New Zealand market. India has not granted market access concessions in sensitive sectors, particularly dairy, Goyal said.

The same applies to several agricultural products, including onions, chickpeas, peas, maize, almonds, artificial honey and sugar.

“With the trade agreement coming into force next month, we can certainly target the doubling of engineering exports in the next five years to \$280-300 million,” Pankaj Chadha, Chairman, EEPC India, said.

The FTA will give fresh momentum to Indian exports through greater market access and diversification in the Indo-Pacific market, said Ajay Sahai of the Federation of Indian Export Organisations.

Nearly 40% of thermal plants ‘running critically low’ on coal

Rishi Ranjan Kala

New Delhi

Almost 38 per cent of the 175 domestic coal-based (DCB) power plants, with a combined installed capacity of 206.75 GW, were critically low on coal stocks as of September 20, highlighting the impact of rain-related supply disruptions amid sustained power demand.

According to the National Power Portal, the number of DCB plants with critical stocks — less than 25 per cent of their normative coal stock requirement — rose to 65 from 60.

More than half of the 15 imported coal-based (ICB) plants, with a combined capacity of 17.77 GW, were also in the critical-stock category. The number of such ICB plants rose to eight from five.

STOCKS DECLINE

Cumulative coal stocks at DCB plants stood around 19.9 million tonnes (mt) against a daily requirement of 2.94 mt. They also held around 5.41 lakh tonnes of imported coal.

ICB plants had around 2.37 mt of imported coal and 72,200 tonnes of domestic coal, against a daily require-



Prolonged rain across the eastern coal belt disrupted mining operations and hampered fuel evacuation

ment of around 1.88 lakh tonnes. The key challenge has been the mismatch between rising demand and coal transportation capacity.

Prolonged rain across the eastern coal belt disrupted mining operations and hampered fuel evacuation. Between April and August, rake loading rose only around 5 per cent and coal receipts 3 per cent, even as coal consumption increased, according to Crisil Intelligence. As a result, incremental coal evacuation was insufficient to replenish in-

ventories at power plants.

To ease the situation, Coal India allowed power plants with fuel supply agreements to lift additional coal by road, alongside rail transport, from September 7, Crisil said.

POWER DEMAND

Coal stocks at power plants act as a buffer to ensure uninterrupted generation. Plants typically receive coal on a daily or continuous basis.

DCB plants held 35.13 mt of coal at the end of July, but stocks fell to 26.04 mt by end-August. They declined further to 25.57 mt on September 1, 23.93 mt on September 5, 22.54 mt on September 10 and 21.23 mt on September 15.

Stocks at ICB plants followed a similar trajectory.

Between April and August, coal consumption by thermal power plants rose around 8 per cent year-on-year to 395 mt, driven by a 9.5 per cent increase in power demand following an abnormally hot summer and a below-normal South-West monsoon.

Cumulative rainfall between June and August was 13 per cent below the long-period average, Crisil Intelligence said.

NSE's mega IPO subscribed 5.71 times led by QIBs; retail portion booked 1.4x

Akshata Gorde

Mumbai

The initial public offering (IPO) of the National Stock Exchange of India (NSE) closed on Monday with the issue subscribed 5.71 times, driven by strong demand from qualified institutional buyers (QIBs) and non-institutional investors (NIIs).

Per the final cumulative demand data on the exchanges, investors bid for 505.81 million shares against the 88.64 million shares on offer. The issue size was ₹22,568.94 crore at the upper end of the ₹1,700-1,785 price band.

QIB, NII DEMAND LEADS

The QIB portion was subscribed 12.68 times, receiving bids for 319.72 million

shares against 25.21 million shares reserved for the category. The NII portion was subscribed 6.55 times, with bids for 123.72 million shares against the 18.9 million shares on offer.

Within the NII category, the portion for applications above ₹10 lakh was subscribed 7.78 times, while that for applications between ₹2 lakh and ₹10 lakh was subscribed 4.09 times.

Retail investors, whose portion remained under-subscribed the first two days, crossed the one-time mark on the final day. The retail portion was subscribed 1.39 times, with bids for 61.31 million shares against 44.10 million shares reserved.

The employee portion was subscribed 2.4 times, receiving bids for 10.84 million shares against 4.33 million

shares reserved.

SECOND-LARGEST IPO

The NSE IPO, which opened on September 17, comprises an offer for sale (OFS) of up to 126.44 million shares by existing shareholders. There is no fresh issue of shares, meaning that the NSE itself will not receive any proceeds from the IPO.

The issue is the second-largest IPO in India after Hyundai Motor India's ₹27,870-crore issue in 2024.

At the upper end of the price band, the IPO values the NSE at about ₹4.42 lakh crore. The exchange is scheduled to list its shares on the BSE on September 24, with allotment expected on September 22.

LONG ROAD TO LISTING

The strong subscription

comes as the NSE prepares for its long-awaited public-market debut, nearly a decade after it first sought to go public in 2016. The plan was held up amid regulatory proceedings, including the long-pending co-location and dark-fibre matters.

The matters were closed through a ₹1,491.21-crore settlement with the regulator in July and were subsequently disposed of by the Supreme Court earlier this month, removing a key legal hurdle for the listing.

NSE's IPO plans moved forward this year after it filed a fresh draft red herring prospectus with the Securities and Exchange Board of India in June. The regulator issued its observations on the IPO on September 4, clearing the way for the exchange to proceed with the issue.

BULL'S EYE



MEDAL HAUL. (from left) Rifle shooters Elavenil Valarivan, Rudranksh Patil and Himanshu Dhillon, along with Puja Ghatkar, the Dronacharya Award-winning coach of Patil, after Dhillon won silver and Patil won bronze in the 10m Air Rifle event at the Asian Games in Japan on Monday. Elavenil clinched two silver medals on Sunday, adding to India's shooting haul **MOORTHY RV**

Auto battle shifts into high gear for the festival season

OEMs woo customers with new products, powertrains and ownership options

Amit Vijay Mohile

Mumbai

Automakers are all set to make the most of the festival season with new products, powertrains and ownership options, intensifying the fight for consumers as vehicle demand accelerates.

Kia Sorento, MG Tomahawk EV and Mahindra Sporteq are set to be followed by Tata Motors' Aeris compact sedan, which will replace the Tigora and be launched on September 25, and JSW's Jetour T2-based SUV before Deepavali.

Maruti Suzuki is introducing automatic transmissions in three CNG models, Kia is entering the factory-fitted CNG segment, Tata Motors is expanding the Sierra line-up, Hyundai is preparing to launch the Bayon, and JSW MG Motor is ex-



FESTIVE PUSH. Automakers are chasing stronger volumes amid a higher base, elevated costs and increased discounting

tending its battery-as-a-service (BaaS) offering to the Cyberster and M9.

Not to be left behind, in the two-wheeler segment, TVS Motor is refreshing its premium motorcycle range, and Royal Enfield is taking its Flying Flea electric motorcycle to Europe.

RISING COSTS

Automakers are chasing

stronger festival volumes while contending with a higher base, elevated commodity and freight costs, and heavier discounting. They remain cautious on production, and are prioritising higher-specification models to protect margins.

Passenger vehicle wholesales surged 36.5 per cent in August, while two-wheeler dispatches grew 10.5 per

cent, three-wheelers 22.8 per cent and commercial vehicles 30.7 per cent, according to SIAM data.

Mahindra & Mahindra will unveil the refreshed three-door Thar on Tuesday, while JSW GreenTech is preparing to launch heavy electric trucks and buses, taking on incumbents such as Tata Motors and Ashok Leyland.

RECORD VOLUMES

Passenger vehicle wholesales hit a record 4,39,309 units in August. Retail registrations rose 16.14 per cent to 4,02,398 units, while rural registrations climbed 24.99 per cent, outpacing the 10.93 per cent growth in urban markets.

Former FADA Chairman Vinkesh Gulati said rural demand is outperforming urban, while CNG vehicles, hybrids and EVs account for

a larger share of early festival bookings. Dealers, however, entered the season with passenger vehicle inventories estimated at 38-40 days.

Honda Cars India is investing ₹450 crore to expand its Bengaluru spare-parts warehouse to 140,000 sq m, supporting its car, two-wheeler and power-products businesses.

Electric scooters and motorcycles are another growth frontier, with Royal Enfield taking its electric push overseas. Deliveries of the Flying Flea C6 will begin in Europe and the UK in October.

Hind Copper ‘working on’ JV with Codelco for 4 Chile blocks

Mithun Dasgupta

Kolkata

With four copper blocks shortlisted in Chile for due diligence, state-run Hindustan Copper Ltd (HCL) is working on forming a joint venture with Chilean strategic partner Codelco to take the project forward.

In an exclusive interview with *businessline*, Hind Copper Chairman and Managing Director Anupam Misra said the transaction advisor is expected to submit a report on the reserves of the four blocks in the next two-three months.

“Certain things are at the study stage. If any one of them is a mature block, it may take six-eight years to start production. It is kind of adding the resource and reserve to our kitty for the country's mineral security,” Misra said.



Anupam Misra, Chairman and MD, Hindustan Copper Ltd

The Kolkata-headquartered company, India's only vertically integrated copper producer, is exploring overseas resources through its collaboration with Codelco, Chile's state-owned copper miner, to strengthen the country's long-term mineral security.

Hind Copper exchanged an MoU with Codelco in April last year in the presence of Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Chilean

President Gabriel Boric. The agreement seeks to identify and undertake joint exploration, mining, and mineral beneficiation by sharing knowledge and expertise.

“Four blocks have been shortlisted in Chile and further work is to be done. A joint venture company with Codelco has to be created first to take it to the next level. So, work is under progress as far as the formation of the JV is concerned, because multiple stakeholders of the two countries will be involved. Therefore, some legal structure has to be created properly. So, our transaction advisors are working on it,” Misra said.

Given the large investment required for the project, other interested Indian PSUs may also join the venture, depending on their investment appetite and risk diversification, he said.

Interview **p2**

Report on reserves in four Chile blocks expected soon: Hindustan Copper CMD

AIMING HIGH. Expecting copper ore production to increase 28% in the current financial year, says Anupam Misra

bl.interview

Mithun Dasgupta
Kolkata

Hindustan Copper Ltd, India's only vertically integrated copper producing company, expects productions of copper ore and metal in concentrate to increase by around 28 per cent and 17 per cent year-on-year, respectively, this financial year, said Anupam Misra, Chairman and MD of the company.

Misra said work was underway regarding a joint venture with the National Copper Corporation of Chile (Codelco). This, after four copper blocks were shortlisted in the South American country earlier this year. The transaction advisor is expected to submit its report on the total reserves in these blocks to Hindustan Copper in the next two to three months.

Edited excerpts:

What contributed to Hindustan Copper's revenue from operations growing 81 per cent y-o-y in Q1?
Three factors contributed to the revenue growth. Copper ore production increased by almost 14 per

cent during the quarter. The quality of ore also increased with metal-in-ore or metal-in-concentrate rising 16 per cent. Sales of metal in concentrate grew 21 per cent. LME Copper prices increased to around \$13,300/mt from around \$12,800/mt in the year-ago period. So, all these factors culminated into the 81 per cent growth in the revenue. With costs remaining almost flat during the period, net profit grew around 163 per cent y-o-y. Total costs remained almost flat as a very small percentage of it is fuel cost for us.

There is also a solar or renewable component within the power mix. So, in terms of fuel, there is not much impact on our cost front due to the West Asia crisis.

What are FY27 production targets?
In the last financial year, we produced around 3.67 million tonnes of copper ore and 27,400 tonnes of metal in concentrate. In FY27, ore production is expected to be around 4.7 million tonnes. For metal, the production is expected to grow to around 32,000 tonnes. We have several mines, too. In the Khetri Copper Complex in Rajasthan, we have two mines — Khetri

“The amendment [to Mines and Minerals Act] will lower compliance burden, support small and medium miners, strengthen domestic mineral supply...

ANUPAM MISRA
Chairman and MD



How far have you progressed on the four blocks in Chile's copper belt for acquisition?

Yes, four blocks have been shortlisted in Chile and further work is to be done. A joint venture company with Codelco has to be created first to take it to the next level. So, work is under progress because multiple stakeholders of the two countries will be involved. Therefore, some legal structure has to be created and our transaction advisors are working on it. As a large investment is required in this project, other interested Indian PSUs may join hands with us. It would depend on their investment appetites and risk diversifications among each other.

What could be the total reserves here?

Certain things are at the study stage at present. The transaction advisor is expected to submit its report to Hindustan Copper in the next two to three months. If any one of them is a mature block, it may take six to eight years to start production. It is kind of adding the resource and reserve to our kitty for India's mineral security.

What are your views on the Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Amendment Act, 2026?

India's mineral resources are fundamental to our national security, energy security and industrial growth. The Act is therefore an important step towards creating a more predictable, uniform and rational fiscal framework. A stable and competitive tax regime is essential to ensure the viability of domestic mining, reduce import dependence and strengthen the competitiveness of Indian industry.

This amendment will lower compliance burden, support small and medium miners, strengthen domestic mineral supply, bolster investor confidence and improve mineral security.

Starbucks to set up its first India GCC in Chennai

Our Bureau
Chennai

US-based Fortune 500 company and coffee chain Starbucks has signed a memorandum of understanding (MoU) with the Tamil Nadu government to set up its Global Capability Centre (GCC) in Chennai. This will be the company's first GCC in India and will

support its existing tech centres in Seattle and Nashville.

JOB OPPORTUNITIES
The centre is expected to provide “high-paying” employment opportunities to 800 technology professionals, a statement from the State government said. The centre will operate independently to the coffee chain's retail stores in India,

● **HIGH CAPABILITY**
Chennai is home to over 405 GCC units, per industry reports

which has been established as a joint venture alongside Tata Consumer Products. The MoU was signed in the presence of C Joseph Vijay, Tamil Nadu Chief Minister,

alongside Anand Varadarajan, Chief Technology Officer of Starbucks and S Keerthana, State Minister for Industries. Chennai's large pool of skilled technology professionals alongside the State government's strong infrastructure and incentives will help the company find new solutions and grow its business, said Varadarajan. A globally renowned com-

pany like Starbucks placing confidence in Tamil Nadu is testament to the capabilities of the State's youth, said Vijay. The MoU with Starbucks follows another US company, Walgreens, inking a pact to set up its GCC here. Chennai is home to over 405 GCC units, according to the most recent estimates of Nasscom-Zinnov GCC Landscape report.

QUICKLY.

Manish Sharma named Escorts' agri biz chief



New Delhi: Escorts Kubota on Monday appointed former Panasonic India Chairman and Chief Executive Manish Sharma as the President of its Agri Business. “Manish will be accountable for Tractors, Agri Solutions, Service and Spare Parts in the domestic and international markets and will focus on delivering annual and mid-term business plan targets,” it said. **OUR BUREAU**

China's SDLG invests ₹300 crore in Gujarat plant

Ahmedabad: Chinese construction equipment manufacturer Shandong Lingong Construction Machinery (SDLG) has invested ₹300 crore to set up a manufacturing plant in Gandhidham, Gujarat, as it looks to expand local production, increase sourcing from Indian suppliers and strengthen its presence in India. The new facility, inaugurated on Monday by SDLG India, will manufacture wheel loaders, excavators and motor graders, with the company targeting an annual production of up to 3,000 units in a phased manner. **OUR BUREAU**

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ONGC strikes deepwater gas in Mahanadi basin under Samudra Manthan initiative

Our Bureau
New Delhi

ONGC has struck gas at a deepwater well in the Mahanadi Offshore Basin, off the Odisha coast, under the Samudra Manthan initiative, the State-run company said on Monday. The exploration & production major struck gas on September 18 at the deepwater well MN-DW18-1-H-D that was drilled to a target depth of 1,623 m. It recorded the gas strike at 1,441-1,452 m interval. The well, located approximately 43 km off Konark, is the first well in the Mahanadi Basin under the campaign. Its relative proximity to the coast offers potential for

● **MAJOR FIND**
● The company struck gas on September 18 in a well located about 43 km off Konark
● Its relative proximity to the coast offers potential for early monetisation
● The discovery strengthens India's efforts to expand its indigenous hydrocarbon resource base

● **MAJOR FRONTIER**
The well is flowing gas with encouraging flow and reservoir pressure for last three days. The discovery strengthens ONGC's deepwater exploration programme and India's efforts to expand its indigenous hydrocarbon resource base.

This find, along with other discoveries in the area, could be a candidate for development through shared facilities enabled by the PNG Rules, 2025, bringing deepwater resources onstream, ONGC said. The well was spudded on July 25 by Oil Minister Hardeep Singh Puri. A month later, ONGC Chairman Arun Kumar Singh, Director (Technology & Field Services) Vikram Saxena, and Director (Exploration) OP Sinha visited the drillship Platinum Explorer and interacted with the team engaged in the drilling campaign.

The government's push for deepwater exploration in the form of the ₹84,084 crore Samudra Manthan, or the National Offshore Exploration Scheme, represents the next major frontier for India's upstream sector, particularly ONGC. During the Maharatna company's post-result analyst call on August 5, ONGC Director (Finance) Anupam Agarwal said the company will play a central role in this national mission. “During Q1 FY27, we commenced drilling of our first deepwater exploratory

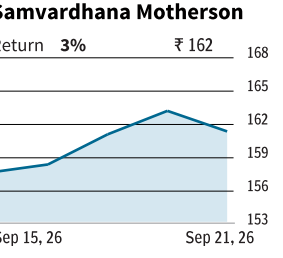
well in the Mahanadi Offshore Basin,” he said then.

EXECUTION ROADMAP
The government is yet to finalise the operational details under Samudra Manthan. The Oil Ministry is working on a year-wise execution road map for drilling, seismic surveys and rig deployment across the KG, Mahanadi, Andaman and Cauvery basins under the initiative, which is now being finalised. “ONGC expects oil prices to settle at \$75 per barrel in the long run. That will help it undertake exploration activities (including deepwater exploration) which were not viable financially at \$60-65,” Motilal Oswal Financial Services said in an August report.

Motherson arm buys 50% stake in RCPL for ₹500 cr

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Samvardhana Motherson International (SAMIL) on Monday said its subsidiary Samvardhana Motherson Adsys Tech will acquire a 50.1 per cent equity stake in Rotary Connectors (RCPL) at an enterprise value of ₹500.4 crore. The transaction is expected to be completed by the end of the current financial year, the company said. Post the transaction, RCPL will become an indirect subsidiary of SAMIL, and its promoters will continue to hold 49.9 per cent stake.



Group's vision of diversifying and scaling its Aerospace and Defence business vertical, particularly in the field of Electrical Wiring Interconnect System, it said. Rotary manufactures military-grade circular connectors and interconnection solutions having diversified applications. RCPL, which has three units in Bengaluru, posted an annual turnover of ₹123.5 crore in FY26.

Japan-based Nippon Express looks at States like U.P. for expansion

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

Japanese logistics provider The NX Group (Nippon Express Group) is considering expanding in India and is looking at States like Uttar Pradesh, where Japanese parks are also coming up. “We learn this current movement of government-to-government relationship and this is a very good sign. How we can explore our network, our footprint, according to this movement... we have just started our study. But, definitely this is a good sign, and Uttar Pradesh itself is a huge market. So, I take it very positively and I want to consider,” said Katsuhito Kobayashi, Executive Officer, South Asia & Oceania,



Katsuhito Kobayashi, Executive Officer, Nippon Express (South Asia, Oceania)

Nippon Express. After Japan, the US, Europe and other parts of Asia, Nippon Express Group is now trying make a “big team in India”, said Kobayashi, especially after the India Semiconductor Mission 2.0. “We are happy to be part of the ecosystem from a logistics point of view... we are very much eager to bring our logistics know-how to India,” he said, adding that the company has been in the country for over 20 years with customers like Tata Electronics. He also said the firm would like to set up its logistics facilities in strategic places nearer to semiconductor factories.

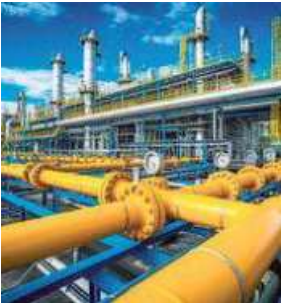
PACT INKED
The NX Group and the ISM also signed a memorandum of understanding at the Semicon India 2026, establishing a framework for collaboration to support the development of India's semiconductor ecosystem. NXP had a turnover of \$153 million in India, in 2024, and aims to achieve around \$380 million by 2028.

Indian Oil board okays gas pipeline worth ₹2,449 crore

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

The board of State-run Indian Oil Corporation (IOCL) on Monday approved the 425 km-long Kochi-Kanniyakumari-Thoothukudi natural gas pipeline (KPTL), which will enhance gas supply in Tamil Nadu and Kerala. IOCL's Board cleared the investment approval for laying, building and operating KTPL at an estimated project cost of ₹2,448.7 crore with a system capacity, including common carrier capacity, of 6.84 million standard cubic meters per day (MSCMD). The common carrier capacity of the pipeline will be at least 1.71 MSCMD. Common carrier capacity refers to the utilised capacity in a pipeline made available to third-parties for transporting gas.

CAPACITY UTILISATION
The pipeline will originate from Petronet LNG's terminal in Kochi and will connect to IOCL's ETBPNMTPL pipeline, which connects Ennore and Thiruvallur in Tamil Nadu to Bengaluru, Puducherry, Nagapattinam, Madurai and Thoothukudi. Once operational, the pipeline will boost the capacity utilisation of Petronet's Kochi LNG terminal, which has been faced with low capacity utilisation due to lack of evacuating infrastructure to major demand centres in Tamil Nadu and Kerala. In FY26, the Kochi terminal, with a capacity of 5 million tonnes per annum (mtpa), recorded a capacity utilisation of mere 26.3 per cent with a total send-out of 1.31 mtpa, its highest since



WHO BENEFITS. The pipeline, once operational, will ensure expansion of CGD networks and gas supply to industries in T.N. and Kerala

the commencement of operations in 2013. In Q1 FY27, its capacity utilisation stood at 23.27 per cent. The pipeline, once operational, will ensure further expansion of city gas distribution (CGD) networks as well as ensure gas supply to industries, particularly in Tamil Nadu and Kerala, an industry source said.

NEW GROWTH AVENUE
Petronet LNG is also said to be exploring LNG bunkering services as a new growth avenue, aligned with the evolving maritime fuel transition and global adoption of LNG as a cleaner marine fuel. Following the expected growth in container and trans-shipment traffic, market interactions suggest a favourable demand outlook for LNG bunkering services from international shipping operators and accordingly, bunkering facilities are being upgraded at Kochi terminal, its FY26 annual report said. Besides, to promote LNG as a cleaner energy source for industrial applications and long-haul transportation, Petronet LNG aims to augment its LNG truck-loading capacity at Kochi.

VISUALLY.

Compiled by **Yashaswani Chauhan** | Graphic **KS Gunasekar**

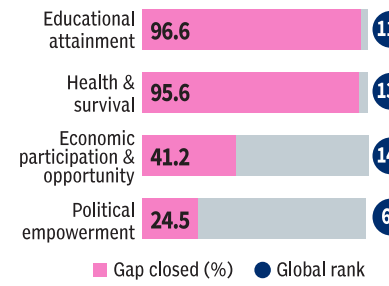
India's widening gender gap

India has closed 64.5 per cent of its overall gender gap, retaining its 131st position among 145 economies in the World Economic Forum's Global Gender Gap Report 2026. India's strongest performance is in educational attainment, closing 96.6 per cent of the gap, while political empowerment remains significantly lower at 24.5 per cent

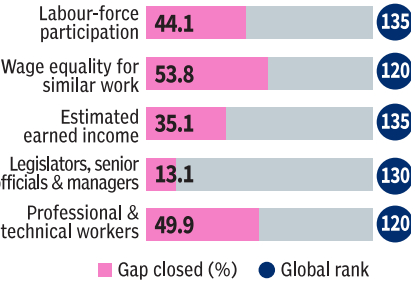
India has closed nearly two-thirds of its overall gender gap



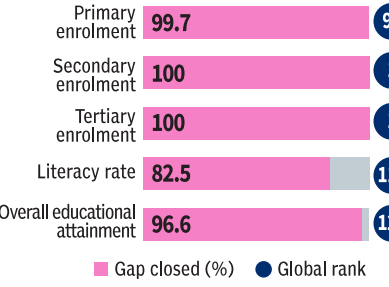
The lowest rank is in economic participation



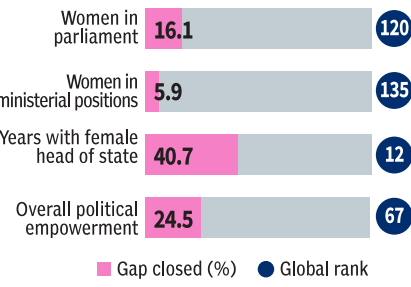
Women's representation in senior jobs remains low



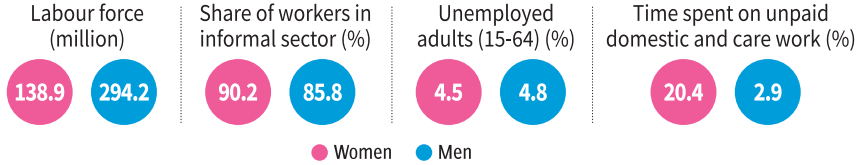
India reaches full parity in secondary and tertiary enrolment



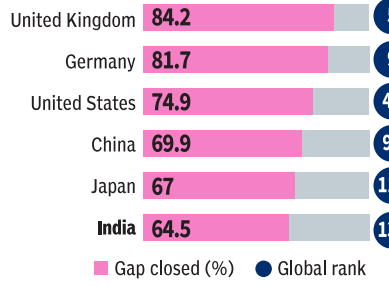
Women's political representation remains uneven



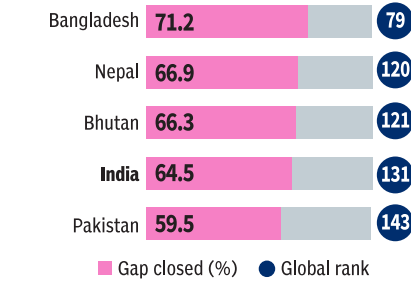
Women make up less than a third of India's labour force



India trails major economies on overall gender parity



And also its neighbouring countries on overall gender parity



Source: Global Gender Gap Report 2026 by World Economic Forum



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Graham Bill’s strange timing

Will the US use the Bill to squeeze India?

Sridhar Krishnaswami

These are difficult times in India-US relations; it is not that the two nations have not been there before. When President Donald Trump signed into law the Lindsey O Graham Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act of 2026, he set in motion the prospect of imposing tariffs of up to 100 per cent on countries importing Russian oil and gas. It does not mean penalties will kick in immediately, but China and India have been put on notice, the former lapping up one half of Russia’s crude exports followed by India at around 37 percent. The percentages vary: for instance, this July, Russia supplied more than half of India’s imports, or more than the combined crude purchased from the UAE, Saudi Arabia, Venezuela, Brazil, Oman and the US.

Initially, the White House was a bit reluctant to support the legislation, but became an enthusiastic cheerleader after sponsors agreed to extend sanctions on Iran for another five years. The Bill first cleared the Senate by an overwhelmingly 86-11 vote, followed by a 262-159 majority in the House of Representatives. The Bill, which had a vocal Democratic Senator co-sponsor, Richard Blumental, also sanctions Russian officials, banks and the so-called shadow fleet that keeps crude flowing.

The overwhelming support for the Graham Bill in the House and Senate did not mean lawmakers were without serious reservations about the legislation. The chief concerns were the discretion given to the President in determining which countries would face tariffs, the rates at which they would be imposed, and if total waivers should be given.

Technically, Turkiye and Europe should also be worried, but an exception clause allows waivers for countries that import less than 15 per cent and have taken “significant steps” to reduce Russian imports. “Why in the world would this Congress or the People’s House give this President unfettered authority to visit more tariffs on the world that will have an adverse economic impact on the American people?” House Minority Leader Hakeem Jeffries asked.

UKRAINE CONFLICT

The legislation, which will take effect on October 18, or 30 days after Trump’s signature, was



TRUMP AND PUTIN. Still at loggerheads? REUTERS

received on expected lines in Moscow and Beijing, with Russia maintaining that the new sanctions would make it more difficult to seek a settlement to the Ukraine conflict.

To Moscow, this is an “unfriendly step” at a time when there was some light on re-starting the stalled dialogue between Moscow and Kyiv by the visit of President Trump’s special envoys to the warring capitals recently. The Graham legislation also comes at a time when world leaders are set to gather in New York for the annual General Assembly session of the United Nations.

CHINA’S TOUGH STANCE

Beijing’s reaction was far more tough, stressing that the new measures had no legal basis and that they contradict international law.

“We always oppose long arm jurisdiction that has no basis in international law or authority of UN Security Council,” said China’s Foreign Ministry. The sanctions Bill also comes at an awkward time for Trump as he readies for the second summit with Chinese President Xi Jinping on September 24-25.

India, for its part, has warned of the “potential implications” to bilateral relations, stressing that all necessary measures would be taken to protect its economic interests. Expectedly, New Delhi has said that it “... remains firmly committed to ensuring energy security for its 1.4 billion people. It will continue to do so through diversified sourcing and on the basis of evolving market dynamics”. With the two nations on the verge of signing a trade deal, there is a fear that Washington could use the Graham Bill to squeeze more out of India by way of concessions.

The writer is a senior journalist who has reported from Washington DC on North America and United Nations



MADHUSUDHAN PILLAI

Reforms in insurance distribution are a key focus of the ongoing comprehensive review of the regulatory framework by the Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI). Insurance distribution in India is done mainly through regulated intermediaries, and a central issue is the remuneration paid to them. Historically, the Insurance Act, 1938, imposed statutory limits on these costs paid by direct insurance companies, which were modified from time to time.

These sub limits were removed to provide operational flexibility under the IRDAI Expenses of Management (EOM) Regulations, 2024, subject to an overall cap of 30 per cent on EOM. However, capping this overall limit has not adequately addressed the underlying problems of excessive intermediary payments, aggressive pricing, governance and insufficient transparency.

IMPORTANCE OF INSURANCE

The insurance industry is a major component of India’s financial system. In FY26, the industry’s annual revenue was approximately ₹13.4 lakh crore, comprising ₹10 lakh crore from life insurance and ₹3.4 lakh crore from non-life insurance. Insurance funds are closely connected with banks, capital markets, taxation and government securities, and thus have wider economic and financial-stability consequences.

After the sector opened up in 2000, a few private insurers sought to acquire profitable business and increase volumes by paying higher acquisition costs. Payments were sometimes classified under expenses such as marketing, publicity, printing, travel and information technology, effectively circumventing prescribed limits with differentials across distribution channels. Over the last two decades, aggressive marketing and competition for business became synonymous with rising intermediary remuneration and lower insurance prices across insurance segments.

Penalties for regulatory violations have not been able to create effective deterrence. The new framework being considered by the IRDAI, which according to reports, proposes to relate penalties to the nature and extent of violations, could be an important improvement. Effort-based remuneration and commission caps on specific statutory lines of business, such as motor third-party premium, may also be proposed.

AGGRESSIVE PRICING

Higher acquisition costs, coupled with lower pricing, are leading a race to the bottom. Recently, the IRDAI cautioned insurers that in the fire portfolio, some insurers were giving 99 per cent discount on standard rates.

Further, the RBI, in its latest Financial Stability Report (June 2026), refers to “a direct financial stability concern” due to



GETTY IMAGES

Time to reset the insurance industry

MORE COVER. Stronger governance, comprehensive public data, transparent intermediary payments, better claims reporting and risk-sensitive solvency standards are essential

the persistent non-compliance to solvency norms by three public sector undertakings from Q4 FY25 to Q4 FY26. This is primarily due to sustained underpricing of key portfolios, including group health and high expenses. Net losses piled up to ₹11,400 crore in FY26 (underwriting losses ₹20,267 crore).

CAPITAL INFUSION

Despite a capital infusion of ₹17,450 crore since FY20, additional infusion of capital is required to keep these companies solvent. Estimates vary, *inter alia*, depending on the plans to sell equity holdings, such as stakes in the NSE, and the proposed change in accounting norms. Some foreign insurers have also found the market difficult.

An American insurance major, with 18 years of operations and total capital and share premium of ₹2,704 crore, had an accumulated loss of ₹1,457 crore as on March 31, 2026. A European insurer that commenced operations in 2008 had accumulated losses of ₹1,315 crore by June 2021 prior to being sold.

There is a gap between formal

Instances of 99 per cent discount on rates or exceedingly high acquisition costs reaching 50-60 per cent point to governance issues

governance systems and actual business practices. Companies file Board-approved policies for all areas of operations with the IRDAI which must be followed diligently. Instances of 99 per cent discount on rates or exceedingly high acquisition costs reaching 50-60 per cent point to governance issues.

The (FSDC) Financial Stability and Development Council is the apex-level mechanism for coordination among financial sector regulators. The RBI can share the direct and indirect payments received by all regulated entities (banks and NBFCs) from insurers over 10 years. SEBI can re verify data in public issues with the IRDAI.

Information concerning intermediaries, claims, legal disputes, pricing and investments in the sector can assist in regulatory decision-making.

Intermediaries: Publish data on intermediaries and their associates who receive payments from insurers, directly or indirectly, in any form. It will also highlight concentration risk in the general insurance market. A IBAI McKinsey report indicates that 10 out of 462 brokers control 70 per cent of the market.

Claims: Disclose the portfolio-wise number and value of claims repudiated by insurers and pending legal cases. Analysis across all insurance portfolios could reveal patterns of disputes and help assess the industry’s trust deficit. Pricing data on major corporate

property and group health insurance premiums and claims over a 10-year period, together with intermediary-related expenses, will help identify persistent under-pricing.

The Insurance Information Bureau (IIB) and insurance councils can assist with relevant data. Investments data on incremental investments in government securities and other approved investments should be monitored, rather than focusing only on gross investment figures. This will highlight insurers’ cash flows and the yearly surplus available for investments. It is pertinent to note that even 25 years after the sector opened up, LIC’s investments represented about 73.3 per cent (₹54.52 lakh crore to ₹74.4 lakh crore) of the industry’s total investments/AUM as of March 2025.

The IRDAI Annual Report Furnishing of Returns Rules, set up in 2000, must be recast with data and analysis to reflect all issues with brokers, corporate agents, web aggregators, online channels, along with GST and funds flow in the current integrated financial system.

Stronger governance, comprehensive public data, transparent intermediary payments, better claims reporting and risk-sensitive solvency standards are essential for the insurance sector to make a substantially greater contribution to economic growth over the next two decades.

The writer is a senior insurance professional

thehindubusinessline.

TWENTY YEARS AGO **TODAY.**

September 22, 2006

1 lakh rural computer kiosks planned

The Government is planning a major digital expansion by setting up one lakh rural Common Service Centres (CSCs), which will basically be computer kiosks, at a total cost of Rs 5,742 crore, through a public-rivate partnership (PPP) mechanism. These centres are expected to bridge the digital divide existing today between the urban and rural areas. .

IDBI board approves UWB merger proposal

The board of IDBI Ltd at its meeting held on Thursday considered the provisions of the draft scheme of amalgamation of the United Western Bank of India (UWB) with IDBI Ltd, said Mr V.P. Shetty, Chairman and Managing Director. Sources in IDBI, however, confirmed that the board had approved the proposal to merge with UWB.

Rlys to tap Net cafes, ATMs for ticket sales

Indian Railways is taking steps to increase points of ticket sales and facilitate online bookings through Internet cafés, ATM networks of banks, and post-offices among others. Of the eight lakh train tickets issued on average every day, only about 25,000 tickets are issued online.

Energy-guzzling AI must rein in emissions, says UN climate chief

Bloomberg

With the world now set to barrel past a key global warming goal, the United Nations’ top climate official took aim at AI goliaths for their growing share of emissions as the UN General Assembly and Climate Week began in New York.

“Energy guzzling artificial intelligence is driving up planet-heating pollution from coal, oil and gas, while ratcheting up energy costs for households and businesses,” said Simon Stiell, Executive Secretary of the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change, in a speech on Monday. “AI leaders are now

on thin ice when it comes to license to operate, and sinking deep under water when it comes to public support,” he added. Data centers still account for a relatively low percentage of global energy use, representing 1.9 per cent of electricity demand last year, but that’s expected to more than double by 2030.

CLIMATE TARGETS

Stiell called for AI companies to set credible climate targets and deliver emissions cuts and increased efficiency. The sector remains relatively opaque. Two of the top companies in the burgeoning business, Anthropic and OpenAI, have yet to



AI’S IMPACT. Unnecessary heat

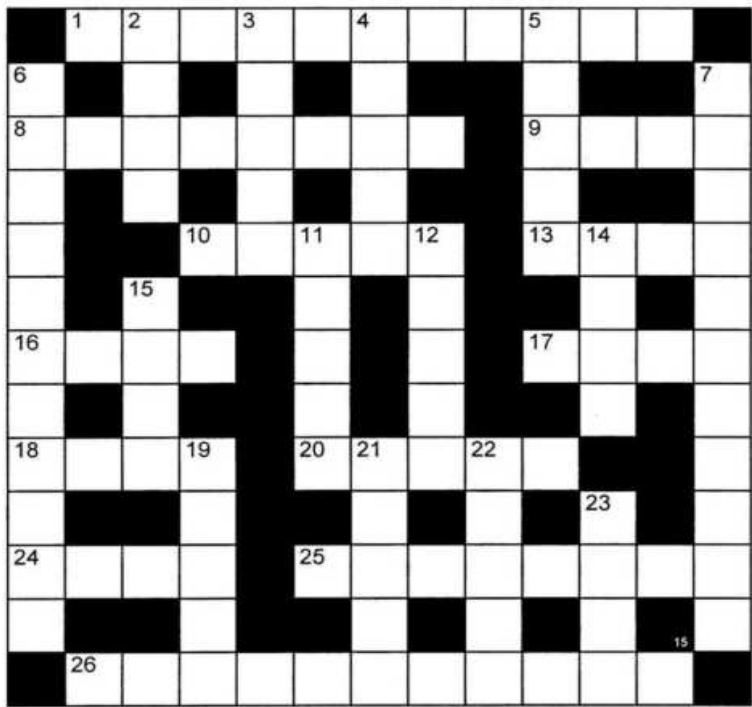
disclose their greenhouse gas emissions, make net-zero pledges or publish sustainability reports. A new California law will require large companies in the state to disclose their emissions starting later this year.

Projections for the emissions impact

of AI in the US are increasing. With a growing pipeline of new AI data centers, the country’s energy-related emissions are expected to reach roughly 4.4 billion metric tonnes by 2035 if developers opt for the cheapest electricity source, according to BNEF’s modeling released Friday. That’s a 6 per cent increase compared with the previous forecast published in May.

Tech companies have spurred the deployment of renewable energy and invested heavily in new sources of carbon-free electricity. Still, “a lot of these developers are turning to [natural] gas and not just clean power,” said Trina White, a BNEF analyst.

● BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2740



EASY

ACROSS

- Tools, utensils (11)
- A clergyman (8)
- Knot on tree (4)
- Pays attention to (5)
- Scraps of cloth (4)
- Get thoroughly wet (4)
- A bluish-white metal (4)
- Bank, mound raised to restrain water (4)
- Pimples (5)
- A gown (4)
- Expansion (8)
- Weakening gradually and insidiously (11)

DOWN

- Not any (4)
- Flavour (5)
- Turn something over (5)
- A small kettledrum (5)
- Diplomats overseas (11)
- Bringing a case against (11)
- Makes things level (5)
- Cylindrical military cap (5)
- Eagerly desirous (4)
- Liquor barrel (4)
- To correct, improve (5)
- Bar of glass triangular in section (5)
- To direct, aim a gun (5)
- Right to retain property against debt (4)

NOT SO EASY

ACROSS

- Things that are musical may contain contracts for lawyers (11)
- Give attentive service to a member of the government (8)
- It will rank, in reverse, with the knot on the tree (4)
- Takes note of a shed blown up around the East (5)
- Newspapers showing the clothing of the poor (4)
- Make one pay heavily to be a heavy drinker (4)
- The last letter in carbon is of metal (4)
- The bank will prevent flooding in a handy key-position (4)
- Manages to descry a rash? (5)
- It’s the right decoration to go with such a vestment (4)
- Laid into ruin by such expansion (8)
- Intriguing against somebody is doing a sapper’s work (11)

DOWN

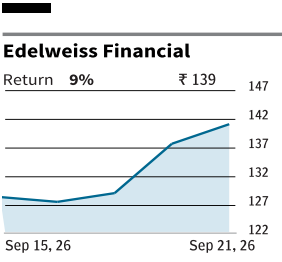
- There isn’t any number one leaves without pigment (4)
- Discernment with which one may try the food (5)
- Riding to the finish, turn it over (5)
- Might rank with leading exponent of the kettledrum (5)
- Diplomats abroad, mass of whom turn south (11)
- Bringing a suit against a professional, etc, using such an arrangement (11)
- It’s no odds it makes things smooth (5)
- Has the go-ahead maybe to make a military cap (5)
- A prima donna turned up looking very keen (4)
- Conservative is to request something to hold his liquor in (4)
- Alter what was written about me in conclusion (5)
- It breaks light into colours and rips apart mauve to begin with (5)
- To coach people for what coaches make up (5)
- A right to distrain on one ill-advised to show it up (4)

SOLUTION: BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2739

ACROSS 1. Material 4. Stow 8. Nil 9. Salvo 10. Inn 11. Contact 12. Token 13. Sympathised 17. Plead 18. Counter 20. Kid 21. Niece 22. Use 23. Dodo 24. Prospect
DOWN 1. Menace 2. Talon 3. Allot 5. Trickle 6. Waning 7. Contribute 9. Stampeding 14. Yielded 15. Spiked 16. Ardent 18. Cheer 19. Truce

QUICKLY.

Edelweiss Fin to raise up to ₹300 crore via NCDs



Mumbai: Edelweiss Financial Services has announced the public issue of secured redeemable non-convertible debentures (NCDs) of up to ₹300 crore (₹150 crore base issue and ₹150 crore green-shoe option). The issue has 10 series carrying fixed coupons and has a tenure of 24 months, 36 months, 60 months and 120 months, it said. Effective annual interest yield on the NCDs ranges from 8.64 per cent per annum to 10 per cent. It intends to utilise at least 75 per cent of the funds raised for repayment/prepayment of interest and principal of existing borrowings. The balance will be utilised for general corporate purposes. The NCD issue, which opened on Monday, will close on October 5. OUR BUREAU

Dilip Buildcon sells solar unit to Alpha Alternatives

New Delhi: Dilip Buildcon Ltd (DBL) on Monday said it has divested its stake in an under-construction solar portfolio to Alpha Alternatives. DBL, in a statement, said that the portfolio had an estimated total project cost of ₹6,263 crore. “DBL, on September 18, executed definitive agreements with Alpha Alternatives for the divestment of its stake in the 10 SPVs undertaking its under-construction solar portfolio, held through DBL Renewable Private Ltd (DBRL),” it said. DBRL and Alpha Alternatives have partnered to fund the equity portion of the project cost in the ratio of 51:49 during the construction period. m

Moneyview sets IPO price band at ₹32-34, eyes ₹750 crore fresh capital

Our Bureau

Moneyview Ltd, one of India's largest digital lending platforms, has fixed its initial public offering price band at ₹32-34 a share, with the issue opening for public subscription on September 24 and closing on September 28. The IPO comprises a fresh issue aggregating up to ₹750 crore and an offer for sale of up to 10.05 crore shares by existing shareholders, including Co-founders Puneet Agarwal and Sanjay Aggarwal. Bids can be made for a minimum lot of 441 shares. The shares will be listed on both the BSE and the NSE. It manages a personal loan portfolio of approximately ₹22,520 crore across 60 lakh borrowers and counts 1.4 crore registered users, roughly 10 per cent of India's working-age population. About 80 per cent of its customers are from tier-2 and -3

Adroit Ind targets ₹151 crore IPO

Our Bureau

Adroit Industries (India) is planning a ₹151 crore IPO on the mainboard. The company will issue 1.12 crore shares, including an OFS of 13.5 lakh shares. The price band has been fixed at ₹126-134 per share. The issue will open for subscription on Wednesday. The net proceeds will be used for funding capex towards procurement of machinery and equipment for enhancement of operations at the Dewas facility, investment in subsidiary Adroit Driveshafts for capex towards machinery and equipment at the Pithampur facility and investment in the subsidiary for repayment of outstanding borrowings. Saurabh Sangla, CMD, said the company had built vertically integrated capabilities spanning forging, precision machining, heat treatment, assembly, balancing and testing.

Nifty rises for fourth straight session; fall in crude oil prices lifts sentiment

GLOBAL HEADWINDS. Nifty Midcap 100, Smallcap 100 settle in the red as geopolitical tension lingers

Anupama Ghosh

Benchmark Nifty50 closed higher for the fourth consecutive session on Monday as declining crude oil prices and improving global cues lifted investor confidence, though gains remained selective and the broader market lagged. The Nifty 50 ended at 23,414.30, up 0.29 per cent, while the Sensex gained 0.76 per cent to close at 74,858.99. Bank Nifty settled 0.2 per cent higher at 56,470. Brent crude slipped below \$101 a barrel, easing for the fourth straight session on expectations of a gradual recovery in Saudi oil output. WTI moderated further to the \$93-94 range. The pull-back in energy prices offered

some near-term relief to markets sensitive to India's import bill, inflation trajectory and corporate margins. However, the Nifty Midcap 100 and Smallcap 100 settled in the red. Within the Nifty 500 universe, 285 stocks ended lower, reflecting weak market breadth. “Improving sentiment ahead of the upcoming US-China talks, renewed hopes of a diplomatic engagement between the US and Iran at the UN, and the decline in oil prices and bond yields provided relief to investors,” said Vinod Nair, Head of Research, Geojit Investments Ltd.

GAINERS, LOSERS Sectoral performance was uneven. Pharma, healthcare, realty and FMCG were the



CONTRASTING STYLE. The FPIs turned sellers once again on Monday by offloading shares worth ₹709.50 crore, even as the DIIIs bought for ₹2,675.27 crore

clear outperformers, each gaining more than 1 per cent, pointing to a rotation toward defensive and domestically oriented plays. Metals and IT ended as the session's laggards. Among Nifty constituents, Eternal and HCL Tech topped the gainers list, while Bharti Airtel and Adani Ports were the notable drags.

Foreign institutional investors turned sellers once again on Monday. They sold shares worth ₹709.5 crore, even as domestic institutions continued their support by investing ₹2,675.27 crore. Persistent FII selling remains a near-term headwind even as oil prices ease.

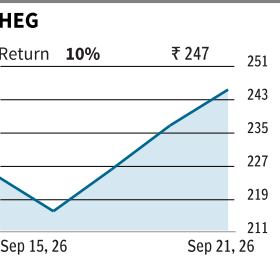
HEG jumps on order win, demerger plans

Our Bureau

Shares of HEG Advanced Materials (formerly known as HEG Ltd) surged nearly 15 per cent over the last three trading sessions, driven by potential gains from the company's demerger and after winning a ₹218 crore order to supply lithium-ion battery banks to Indus Towers. The company's shares surged from ₹215 on September 17 to ₹248 on September 21, a 15 per cent gain on the NSE.

Towers to supply lithium-ion battery banks. The order has to be fulfilled before March 31 next year, it said.

DEMERGER BOOSTER HEG's shares also benefited from the value creation potential of its ongoing demerger, under which the graphite electrodes business will move into HEG Graphite, which will subsequently be renamed HEG and taken forward as a separately listed, pure-play graphite electrodes company. The company is expected to be listed by the end of October. The current listed company, HEG Advanced Materials, retains the advanced materials, battery energy



solutions and green power businesses. Those who held shares on the record date of September 7 will receive one share in the graphite company for every one share held of HEG Advanced Materials. Ravi Jhunjhunwala has been leading the graphite company as Chairman, MD and CEO from September 1,

and will continue on the advanced materials company's board in a non-executive capacity. Meanwhile, Riju Jhunjhunwala was appointed Chairman, MD and CEO of HEG Advanced Materials for a five-year term, subject to shareholder approval. Riju Jhunjhunwala had earlier said that the demerger would create two focused and independently valued businesses, each with a clear strategy, disciplined capital allocation and the flexibility to pursue its own growth path. “We believe this sharper focus will enable each business to unlock its full potential while creating sustainable, long-term value for our shareholders,” he said.

BROKER'S CALL.

Geojit Investments

SUN PHARMA (BUY) Target: ₹2,070 CMP: ₹1,868 Sun Pharmaceutical is India's largest pharmaceutical company and a leading global specialty generics company. It develops, manufactures and markets branded and generic formulations and active pharmaceutical ingredients. In Q1FY27, consolidated revenue from operations rose 10.5 per cent y-o-y to ₹15,300 crore, on strong growth in the India formulations business and sustained momentum in the Innovative Medicines portfolio. The company expects high single digit growth in the business this year led by speciality and domestic segments. The Global Specialty business (22 per cent of sales) delivered broad-based growth, led by strong performance from ILMUYA and ODOMZO, while recent launches such as Leqselvi and Unloxcyt continue to gain traction, supporting growth prospects. The recent approval of semaglutide in multiple markets, steady performance of its flagship brands such as Ilumya and progress in the commercialisation of new speciality products highlight its focus on innovation-led growth. The proposed Organon acquisition is expected to broaden its therapeutic presence through the Women's Health and Biosimilars portfolios while further enhancing its global reach. Sun Pharma continued to strengthen its leadership position in the Indian pharmaceutical market (8.4 per cent Market share), with growth largely driven by volumes and new product launches. Hence, we retain our Buy rating on the stock, with a revised target price of ₹2,070, based on 30x FY28E adj. EPS.

HDFC Securities

INDO-MIM (BUY) Target: ₹1,407 CMP: ₹1,163.60 Indo-MIM Ltd (IML) is the world's largest manufacturer of precision engineering components using the metal injection molding (MIM) technology with a market share of about 7 per cent in CY25. Over the years, IML has well-entrenched itself into the manufacturing innovation ecosystem in the US and is enjoying leading market share with top US MNCs. We believe IML has only scratched the surface, and next-generation innovations such as humanoids, satellite internet, space travel, aerospace engineering, data centres and automation equipment for mobile lines will provide significant optionality over the next few years. The company will be a key beneficiary of the ex-China supply chain for US manufacturing, including large capex outlays by the US Department of Defence to strengthen national security including drone programmes. IML is well-insulated against tariff frictions as it has onsite manufacturing, and the only constraints to growth should be how quickly it can bring more capacities to capture the growth upside. High share of client wallet, extremely stringent entry barriers in innovation programs, and onsite presence are tough to replicate. This may cause IML valuation multiple to rerate over the next few years and trade in line or at a premium to MNC cap goods multiple. We initiate coverage on Indo-MIM with a Buy and a target price of ₹1,407 at 54x Sept-28E EPS.

businessline is not responsible for the recommendations sourced from third party brokerages. Reports may be sent to: blmarketwatch@gmail.com

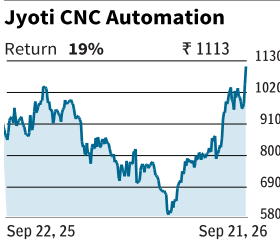
TODAY'S PICK.

Jyoti CNC Automation (₹1,113.60): BUY

Gurumurthy K

bl. research bureau The short-term outlook is bullish for Jyoti CNC Automation. The stock has surged over 13 per cent in the last two trading days. This indicates that the upmove has gained momentum.

Monday's 6 per cent surge has taken the share price well above the key resistance level of ₹1,060. The region between ₹1,060 and ₹1,040 will now act as a good support zone and limit the downside. The Jyoti CNC Automation share price can rise to ₹1,300 in the coming weeks. Traders can buy the shares now at ₹1,114. Accumulate on dips at ₹1,080. Keep the stop-loss at ₹995. Trail



the stop-loss up to ₹1,130 as soon as the stock goes up to ₹1,160. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹1,170 and ₹1,220 when the share price touches ₹1,195 and ₹1,260 respectively. Exit the long positions at ₹1,290. Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis. There is a risk of loss in trading

Day trading guide

23447 » Nifty 50 Futures

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
23380	23300	23480	23570	Go long on a break above 23480. Keep the stop-loss at 23450

₹741 » HDFC Bank

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
737	731	743	752	Go long only above 743. Stop-loss can be kept at 740

₹1040 » Infosys

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1025	1000	1050	1070	Go short now and at 1037. Keep the stop-loss at 1055

₹267 » ITC

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
265	263	269	270	Wait for dips. Go long at 266 with a stop-loss at 264

₹235 » ONGC

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
234	232	236	240	Take fresh longs above 236. Keep the stop-loss at 235

₹1247 » Reliance Ind.

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1230	1210	1260	1275	Go long on dips at 1235. Stop-loss can be kept at 1225

₹996 » SBI

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
990	985	1000	1015	Go long on a break above 1000 with a stop-loss at 995

₹2136 » TCS

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
2115	2075	2160	2190	Go short on a rise at 2145 and 2155 with a stop-loss at 2165

S1, S2: Support 1 & 2; R1, R2: Resistance 1 & 2.

NSE's options-heavy revenue mix in focus ahead of listing

Akshata Gorde

Options remain the National Stock Exchange's (NSE) biggest earnings engine, accounting for about 60 per cent of operating revenue, even as SEBI has been tightening rules around derivatives trading. The regulatory measures and consequent moderation in volumes have already begun to show up in the exchange's financial performance, putting its dependence on options in focus as it gets listed.

The ₹22,569-crore IPO, which closed on Monday, values the country's largest stock exchange at about ₹4.42 lakh crore at the upper end of its ₹1,700-1,785 price band. The issue was fully subscribed by the second day, and NSE shares will list on September 24. Transaction charges accounted for 78.65 per cent of the NSE's operating revenue in FY26, with options alone contributing 60.22 per cent. Weekly index options, the segment most exposed to regulatory changes over the past two years, contributed 46 per cent of operating revenue.

'KEY FACTORS'

"Its high dependence on transaction charges, particularly from the options business, increases sensitivity to trading activity," Religare Broking said, adding that regulatory changes affecting trading products, market structure or transaction activity could adversely impact volumes, revenue and financial performance. The impact has already been visible. The NSE's operating revenue fell 3.15 per cent year-on-year in FY26, while profit declined 15.47 per cent. Angel One attributed the moderation partly to SEBI's derivatives measures and higher securities transaction tax, which it said



reduced equity options notional average daily turnover to ₹258.28 lakh crore from ₹312.84 lakh crore. The NSE also lost market share to the BSE in options premium turnover, bringing its market share down from 96.86 per cent in FY24 to 74.71 per cent in FY26 and 68.48 per cent in the June quarter, making the largest single revenue line also losing share, Yes Securities said.

OPTIONS TRACTION

The BSE, meanwhile, has gained traction in the options segment. "This competitive shift could weigh on NSE's transaction revenue growth and warrants a cautious near-term view," Nirmal Bang Research said. The dependence on options is partly cushioned by the NSE's dominance in other segments and growth in non-transaction businesses. It had about 93 per cent market share in cash equities and nearly 100 per cent in equity futures in FY26. Non-transaction revenue increased from 17.93 per cent of operating revenue in FY24 to 21.35 per cent in FY26, led by data centre racks, connectivity, data feeds and index licensing, which are largely subscription-based and less dependent on trading volumes. At the upper end of the price band, the NSE is valued at 42.9 times FY26 earnings, "leaving limited room for earnings disappointments," Religare Broking said, adding that the sustainability of earnings growth would depend on trading activity, regulatory stability and continued market participation.

Nifty 50 Movers					▲ 67.90 pts.
	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	WN(%)	
Reliance Ind	1247.40	31.00	19.15	7.86	
HDFC Bank	739.50	28.44	13.80	10.57	
Eternal Ltd.	335.90	14.30	748.63	2.27	
ITC	267.00	9.90	16.57	2.40	
ICI Bank	1345.00	9.55	16.15	8.99	
Sun Pharma	1868.90	7.31	37.01	1.85	
HCL Tech	1281.00	7.30	19.94	1.26	
Titan	4875.00	6.90	75.14	1.88	
TCS	2128.70	5.29	15.39	2.03	
L&T	3994.80	5.06	27.17	4.27	
Bharat Elec	398.50	4.07	47.38	1.33	
Kotak Bank	414.80	3.70	20.33	2.85	
Tech Mahindra	1558.50	2.97	29.58	0.92	
Hind Unilever	1947.00	2.91	43.59	1.61	
NTPC	326.40	2.85	11.17	1.44	
Max Healthcare	1066.60	2.81	71.23	0.74	
Coal India	414.70	2.51	8.19	0.93	
SBI Life	1756.00	2.45	67.73	0.74	
ONGC	235.63	2.40	6.62	0.85	
UltraTech Cement	11100.00	2.22	38.16	1.23	
HDFC Life	559.40	1.99	61.12	0.56	
NestleIndia	1385.00	1.97	70.08	0.93	
Dr Reddy's Lab	1195.30	1.77	34.42	0.68	
Maruti Suzuki	12153.00	1.43	26.66	1.48	
Bajaj Auto	11460.00	1.11	27.73	1.18	
Int'l GloBev	4941.00	1.04	0.00	1.04	
TataConsumerProduct	1000.60	0.65	60.30	0.61	
M&M	3055.30	0.64	18.77	2.55	
Shriram Finance Ltd.	1106.80	0.55	21.03	1.32	
Jio Financial Services Ltd.	2239.97	0.06	73.48	0.70	
Eicher Motors	7512.50	-0.11	35.72	0.97	
State Bank	996.00	-0.18	10.25	3.84	
Bajaj Finserv	1849.80	-0.34	14.35	1.00	
Trent Ltd.	2815.50	-0.62	82.73	0.87	
Apollo Hosp	8912.00	-0.73	59.00	0.86	
Tata Motors PV	301.65	-0.98	0.00	0.59	
Cipla	1386.10	-1.03	33.37	0.73	
Asian Paints	2440.30	-1.09	48.39	1.03	
Wipro	164.55	-1.35	12.27	0.42	
JSW Steel	1268.60	-1.43	11.08	1.11	
Hindalco	981.20	-1.68	13.04	1.33	
Adani Enter	2975.20	-2.84	51.52	0.80	
Grasim Ind	3166.00	-3.56	18.93	1.11	
Tata Steel	183.40	-3.87	20.33	1.41	
PowerGrid Corp	266.10	-4.16	15.57	1.12	
Axis Bank	1250.00	-4.39	13.92	3.35	
Adani Ports	1787.10	-5.95	31.38	1.23	
Infosys	1038.50	-9.89	13.89	3.40	
Bajaj Finance	1021.30	-11.13	30.80	2.55	
Bharti Airtel	1830.20	-41.93	30.63	5.19	
Pts: Impact on index movement					
Nifty Next 50 Movers					▲ 58.55 pts.
	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	WN(%)	
Torrent Pharma	4970.00	55.42	87.68	2.94	
Solar Industries	19265.00	50.26	85.02	1.89	
Cg Power & Ind Sol	910.00	35.87	115.76	2.52	
Indian Hotels Co.	745.10	33.26	45.93	2.64	
DIF	660.25	29.64	36.76	1.71	
AvenueSuper	3800.40	23.65	81.07	2.47	
United Spirits	1397.00	22.32	60.23	1.66	
Bajaj Holdings	11409.00	15.98	14.12	1.99	
Bosch	47565.00	14.24	59.36	1.66	
HindustanAeronautics	4826.00	14.17	34.62	3.69	
Divis Lab	9410.50	13.11	85.41	4.82	
Varun Beverages	425.00	12.12	42.16	2.34	
Jindal Steel	1130.60	11.95	42.58	1.69	
Tata Motors Cv	444.50	9.71	39.09	3.74	
Power Finance	344.75	9.31	3.38	2.02	
Hdfc Amc	2440.00	8.89	35.48	2.01	
Union Bank	178.09	8.59	6.59	1.39	
Britannia Ind	5023.00	8.56	46.35	2.39	
Punjab Natl Bank	118.00	7.31	6.13	1.64	
Ambuja Cements	390.75	4.44	18.72	0.98	
SamvardhanaInternat	162.91	4.37	37.75	2.90	
MuthootFin	2854.20	4.08	10.00	1.23	
LuminTree	4280.00	1.32	24.43	1.60	
Pidilifind	1573.20	0.99	59.83	1.97	
ZydusIntesciences	1161.00	0.73	25.44	1.17	
Abb India	7271.00	0.08	99.07	1.54	
Adani Power	206.55	-0.60	27.41	3.46	
Canara Bank	123.70	-0.78	5.66	1.68	
Shree Cement	22550.00	-1.94	49.73	1.22	
Siemens Energy India	3214.70	-3.42	30.84	2.15	
Indian OilCorp	136.53	-5.10	5.40	2.06	
MacroTech Developers	1138.00	-5.40	27.54	1.27	
Hindus Zinc	591.80	-5.87	14.65	1.15	
Rural Elec	310.20	-6.53	5.09	1.56	
Siemens	3887.00	-6.91	95.28	1.39	
Bank Of Baroda	233.64	-7.01	6.57	1.75	
Bpcl	312.75	-7.36	7.97	2.56	
Indian Railway Finance Corp	80.22	-7.48	14.58	0.65	
Gail (India)	172.61	-10.11	11.50	1.88	
Mazagon Dock	2232.00	-10.60	31.55	0.68	
Tvs Motor Comp.	4155.00	-11.13	54.82	3.93	
Tata Capital	94.70	-11.19	26.63	0.70	
Adani Ports	127.76	-12.76	59.27	2.76	
Godrej Consumer	867.00	-14.60	46.39	1.41	
Hyndai Motor India	214.40	-26.85	35.19	2.13	
AdaniGreen Energy	1303.60	-30.11	100.06	1.76	
Vedanta	26.00	-34.99	6.10	1.78	
Adani Energy Solutions	1397.60	-36.74	54.33	1.85	
Tata Power 15	232.75	-37.08	22.12	2.47	
Cholamandlamin&Fin	1764.00	-45.26	26.15	3.08	
Pts: Impact on index movement					

QUICKLY.

RBI sells ₹25,000 cr G-Secs in second OMO tranche

Mumbai: The Reserve Bank of India on Monday accepted bids worth ₹25,000 crore in the second tranche of its open market operation (OMO) sale of government securities, as it stepped up efforts to absorb surplus liquidity from the banking system. The RBI accepted ₹11,512 crore of the 6.10 per cent GS 2031, ₹8,758 crore of the 7.95 per cent GS 2032, ₹2,300 crore of the 6.75 per cent GS 2029, ₹2,250 crore of the 7.17 per cent GS 2030, and ₹180 crore of the 7.17 per cent GS 2028, according to the release. **PTI**

Chinese President Xi to visit US from Sept 23 to 25

Beijing: Chinese President Xi Jinping will visit Washington from September 23 to 25 for summit talks with his US counterpart Donald Trump, marking their second meeting in six months, a development Beijing has described as a “milestone of historic significance”. Xi will visit the US for three days at the invitation of Trump, Foreign Ministry spokesperson Guo Jiakun announced at a media briefing here on Monday. **PTI**

Core sector growth down to 4.8% in Aug, dragged by energy supply issues, fertilizer output decline

Our Bureau

New Delhi

Production growth of nine key infrastructure sectors slowed to a three-month low of 4.8 per cent in August, according to the latest government data released on Monday. Growth rate was 5 per cent in July and 6.2 per cent in August last year. During April-August, the pace of growth was higher at 4.3 per cent compared to 2.4 per cent in the same period of 2025-26. Devendra Kumar Pant, Chief Economist with India Ratings & Research, said that

India to study US’ Russia sanctions law, says Goyal

UNDER REVIEW. Govt will discuss the matter at appropriate time: Commerce Minister

Amiti Sen

New Delhi

India will study the details that are emerging after US President Donald Trump signed legislation giving him the authority to impose up to 100 per cent tariffs on major buyers of Russian energy, including India, and will discuss the matter at an appropriate time, Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal has said.

“The details are now emerging. We will study them and discuss the matter at an appropriate time,” Goyal said on Monday.

The legislation, the Lindsey O Graham Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act of 2026, was signed into law by Trump on September 18. The law provides for second-ary import duties of up to 100 per cent on goods from top buyers of Russian crude and gas. The additional tariff is not automatic and would depend on a decision by the US administration. The law



Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal **ANI**

does not name any country, and it is unclear how the US will decide which ones qualify.

UNCERTAINTY PERSISTS

The development adds a fresh layer of uncertainty to India-US trade ties, as the two countries negotiate a Bilateral Trade Agreement (BTA). The two sides announced in February that they had finalised the framework for the first phase, but changes in the US tariff

structure led to further negotiations. Goyal has said India would finalise the pact once Washington offers Indian exporters a competitive tariff rate *vis-a-vis* competing countries.

Goyal is scheduled to visit the US later this month to attend the G20 Trade Ministerial in Milwaukee on September 30-October 1, at the invitation of the USTR Jamieson. Commerce Secretary Rajesh Agrawal earlier said the Minister may hold

bilateral talks with Greer, with trade pact issues to figure in the discussions.

The Minister’s measured response follows a sharper message from the Ministry of External Affairs last week, after the US House of Representatives approved the bill. The MEA cautioned that targeting India through the legislation could have adverse implications for the bilateral relationship and may affect the global energy market. It also said India’s energy procurement and response to trade measures would be guided by its national interests.

TALKS WITH CANADA

PTI adds: The next round of talks for a Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement between India and Canada will be held from October 5, Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal said on Monday.

“The next 90 days should be a very defining period in the Canada-India relationship,” he said.



the resolution to West Asia crisis, which appears to be distant as off now. “Ind-Ra expects core sector to grow around 5 per cent in September and October 2026,” Pant said.

According to Madan Sabnavis, Chief Economist with Bank of Baroda, core sector growth has been coming

down mainly due to energy sector of coal, crude, gas. Higher growth in refinery products due to exports and domestic consumption. Fertilizer production down as sowing season slows down and imports increase. “We may expect IIP growth of 6-6.5 per cent,” he said.

Rahul Agrawal, Principal Economist at ICRA Ltd Fertiliser, said that fertilizer output contracted for the sixth consecutive month in August, following the onset of the West Asia crisis, with the pace of the same widening to double digits in the month. Among the construction-related sectors, while

steel output growth inched up slightly in August, it remained lacklustre at just 3.4 per cent. However, cement output expanded by double digits for the second straight month in August 2026.

Besides, electricity generation surged by 11.6 per cent in August, amid healthy growth in demand, supporting the overall growth in core output in the month. Excluding this, “core output rose by just 1.6 per cent in the month (vs. +3.4 per cent in July 2026). Given these trends, “we expect the IIP growth to ease to 5-6 per cent in August 2026 from 6.7 per cent in July 2026,” Agrawal said.

Industry must ensure workers get a fair share of gains: CEA

Our Bureau

New Delhi



GROWTH PUSH. Chief Economic Advisor V Anantha Nageswaran addressing the gathering at AIMA’s 53rd National Management Convention in New Delhi on Monday **PTI**

ity lies with the governments.”

COST OF DOING BIZ

On the government part, Nageswaran said it must ensure cheaper power, affordable land and reduce the compliance burden so that the cost of doing business is lowered.

“Lowering the cost of doing business is at the core of what governments can and should do to create jobs. Governments do not themselves create lasting jobs. What they can do is to make it easier for economic activity to occur, and it is that activity carried out by businesses that creates jobs,” he said.

TO GROW FASTER

Stressing that India’s economic challenge is no longer simply to grow faster, the CEA said, but to ensure that growth translates into better jobs, higher wages and greater economic security for ordinary Indians. He also argued that the country must now focus on turning growth into “transformation”.

India’s growth outlook was increasingly settled, with even cautious forecasts placing medium-term an-

nual growth at around 6.5-7 per cent, he said, adding that the economy grew 7.8 per cent in the first quarter despite headwinds from the West Asia crisis.

Growth, he said, “measures how much larger the economy becomes each year. Transformation is about the character of that growth as to who benefits from it, how many workers move from insecure employment into productive and stable jobs, and whether households actually experience an improvement in their standard of living.

He pointed to measures taken since the government returned to office in June 2024, including an employment-focused first Budget, trade agreements aimed at opening foreign markets, efforts to reduce compliance requirements, fiscal consolidation, stronger banking-sector balance sheets and improved access to credit.

“Growth becomes transformation when it is fair,” the CEA said, stressing that fairness should be understood not merely as a moral principle but in the “plain accounting sense” of who receives what from the wealth being created.

Demand for 5-day week for banks continues to be examined: FinMin

Our Bureau

New Delhi

Amid a strike call by unions, the Finance Ministry on Monday said the demand for a five-day week for banks “continues to be examined”. It also urged bank employees not to go on strike.

Bank unions have given call for 3-day strike between September 28 and 30. This is a part of series of strikes that started on September 11 and is like to extend to the proposed indefinite strike from October 28. There are two principal demands - implementation of five-day banking, and withdrawal of the performance linked incentive (PLI) scheme. The government has decided to keep the PLI scheme in abeyance

On Monday, Financial Services Secretary Sanjay Lohia chaired a meeting with heads of public sector banks and regional rural banks. Post the meeting, an official statement said: “Given that most concerns of the Unions have been substantially addressed, that the remaining demand continues to be examined, and that the Government continues to proactively introduce welfare measures for the banking workforce, bank employees are urged to refrain from resorting to strikes, work towards resolving issues through dialogue, and ensure that banking services remain uninterrupted.”

SERVICE CONTINUITY

On the issue of five-day week, the statement em-

phasised that banking as a service is relied upon by every citizen, and its continuity directly affects the everyday lives of the general public. It may be recalled that, in the interests of bank employees, the government declared the 2nd and 4th Saturdays of every month as public holidays for Public Sector Banks in 2015. “The remaining Saturdays continue to serve as an important opportunity for many citizens to access banking services easily,” it said.

Further, it noted that the proposed 3-day strike period also coincides with the half-yearly closing of banks on September 30, a date of particular significance for reconciliation, provisioning, and treasury and market operations.

Banks mobilise \$133 billion via FCNR(B) deposits: RBI

Our Bureau

Mumbai

Banks have mobilised \$132.980 billion via foreign currency non-resident (Bank)/ FCNR(B) deposits between June 8 and August 31, 2026, under the central bank’s limited period special US dollar-rupee forex swap facility, per updated figures published by the Reserve Bank of India. This updated

FCNR (B) deposit mobilisation figure is \$5.574 billion higher than the earlier figure of \$127.226 billion (pending final reporting, accounting and reconciliation) that RBI published on September 2.

The updated figures come in the wake of the aforementioned forex swap facility for FCNR(B) deposits mobilised by banks ending on September 11, 2026.

With the special 85-day FCNR (B) deposit scheme,

which offered higher interest rate of 6-7 per cent thereabouts, ending on August 31, mobilisation by banks under the overseas foreign currency borrowing (OFCB) route too has slowed.

\$60 MILLION VIA OFCBs

Banks raised only \$60 million via OFCBs between September 1 and September 18. The proceeds of these borrowings were being channelised by banks to offer NRI

customers leverage, which, in turn, was placed as a large quantum FCNR(B) deposit. Till September 18, Banks mopped up \$5.320 billion against \$5.260 billion till August 31, 2026. Funds mobilised by public sector enterprises under the external commercial borrowing (ECB) route continues at a decent pace. Till September 18, these enterprises mopped up \$5.296 billion against \$3.891 billion till Au-

gust 31, 2026. Overall, foreign capital flows aggregating \$143.596 billion have come in between June 8 and August 31, 2026, under the FCNR (B), OFCB and ECB routes against \$136.377 billion during the 85-day period ending August 31, 2026. RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra had announced on June 5 measures to attract foreign capital amid volatility in the rupee due to hardening oil prices and FPI outflows.

Colombo Port City woos Indian firms with ‘India-plus-one’ pitch

T E Raja Simhan

Chennai



Thulchi Aluwihare, Deputy Managing Director, CHEC Port City Colombo

Sri Lanka’s Colombo Port City is stepping up efforts to attract Indian companies, positioning the 269-hectare services hub adjacent to the Colombo port, as an “India-plus-one” destination for business continuity, disaster recovery and global services operations.

Thulchi Aluwihare, Deputy Managing Director, CHEC Port City Colombo, said, “We want to leverage proximity to India, connectivity and our investor-friendly regulatory framework to complement the operations of Indian companies rather than replace their existing bases in the country.”

Designed to attract high-value FDI, Port City Colombo facilitates sectors including financial services, IT and digital services, global trading, maritime and logistics, professional services, and regional headquarters operations.

Upon completion, the estimated \$15 billion development is expected to generate significant employment, knowledge transfer, and long-term economic growth for Sri Lanka, he told *businessline*.

Aluwihare pointed to the presence of major shipping companies in Chennai and Mumbai as an opportunity for Port City to host smaller disaster-recovery or business-continuity centres.

REGULATORY RELIEF

Port City is being developed as a 100 per cent services-export zone and does not per-

mit manufacturing. Among its key features for Indian businesses is the recognition of the Indian rupee as legal tender for transactions, although the US dollar remains the most widely used currency. Indian companies can deploy any number of Indian employees, with no cap on foreign employees relative to local staff.

The development also provides longer-duration visas, with employees eligible for five-year resident visas and directors and investors for 10 years, he said.

A dedicated international commercial arbitration centre has been established for disputes involving businesses operating within Port City.

The Port City Economic Commission functions as a single-window investment facilitator for approvals. Companies operating within the zone also benefit from relaxed foreign-exchange rules, with the movement of capital into and out of the zone exempt from certain restrictions applicable else-

where in Sri Lanka, he added. Aluwihare said around 250 companies are currently operating under the Port City Special Economic Zone law, occupying about 1.3 million square feet of office space. While vertical development within Port City is still under way, these companies are currently operating from offices elsewhere in Colombo under the Port City framework.

PRIORITY MARKET

India and the UAE are currently priority markets for Port City. About 20 per cent of the 250 companies are from the UAE, while Singapore is another significant market.

For Indian companies, Port City is pitching geographical proximity and connectivity as key advantages. Colombo is less than an hour’s flight from southern India. “We are actively engaging with Indian companies and developers and was hoping to attract its first significant Indian investments,” he added.

Steel prices hit 4-year high amid strong demand

Suresh P Iyengar

Mumbai

Steel prices have surged to four-year high of ₹63,800 a tonne after an increase ₹1,600 a tonne week-on-week (w-on-w) ended September 18, on the back of restocking by the trade and distributors amid fear of further rally in prices.

Rebar prices rose ₹2,300 a tonne w-on-w to ₹60,450 a tonne, marking a renewed uptrend after seasonal moderation in June quarter.

BigMint benchmark Mumbai HRC assessment rose by ₹1,200 a tonne to ₹63,900 a tonne while CRC prices jumped ₹1,300 a tonne to ₹73,500 a tonne.

Major producers increased HRC prices by about ₹750-1,750 a tonne and CRC prices by ₹1,500-2,000 a tonne, prompting corresponding increased across trade markets, it said.

Post-monsoon revival of infrastructure projects also supported domestic demand and prices.

On the cost front, imported coking coal prices moved up 22 per cent to \$283 a tonne against an average of



RENEWED UPTREND. Major producers increased HRC prices by ₹750-1,750 a tonne and CRC prices by ₹1,500-2,000 a tonne

\$232 a tonne in August due to growing supply concerns.

NMDC increased 65.5 per cent FE content iron ore prices by ₹150 per tonne to ₹5,400 per tonne but retained the lower grade 64 per cent fines at ₹4,500 a tonne.

Geopolitical tensions continue to exert pressure on raw-material, freight and supply-chain volatility. The steel supply in the domestic markets also remained tight.

CRUDE STEEL

India’s crude steel production edged down 0.1 per cent year-on-year to 14.1 million tonne in August, while finished steel consumption

The rise in steel prices will impact MSMEs, particularly in the downstream sectors such as auto components, engineering, fasteners, fabrication and construction-linked segments, he said.

MARGIN PRESSURE

The immediate impact is likely to be margin pressure and higher working-capital requirements, as smaller manufacturers generally have less pricing power than integrated steelmakers and large OEMs, he added.

Vandana Bharti, Head of Commodity Research, SMC Global Securities, said driven by geopolitical tensions, global and regional steel markets face selective upward pressure primarily from escalating energy, power generation and maritime freight overheads, establishing a structural cost floor beneath raw materials such as imported ferrous scrap.

Instead of triggering runaway price spikes, these cost-push factors are counter-balanced by subdued real estate demand in key consumer markets such as China, leaving broader markets relatively range-bound, she said.

CM
YK

QUICKLY.

EaseMyTrip promoter
Pitti chargesheeted



New Delhi/Raipur: The Enforcement Directorate has chargesheeted EaseMyTrip Co-founder Nishant Pitti in the Mahadev online betting app money laundering case, charging him with “facilitating” proceeds of illegal betting into the equity market under the guise of foreign portfolio investments. **PH**

JioStar partners with SES for service expansion

Mumbai: Reliance Industries' streaming platform JioStar has announced a new multi-year deal with Luxembourg-based space solutions company SES for satellite distribution services to provide JioStar's portfolio of television channels across the Indian sub-continent. JioStar can now distribute its channels reliably to cable, DTH and broadcast distribution networks across the region, ensuring consistent, high-quality delivery to millions of households using IS-20 satellites. This makes JioStar part of SES's established video neighbourhood serving broadcasters, media companies, telecom operators and government customers across Europe, West Asia, Africa and the Asia-Pacific region. **OUR BUREAU**

Eighth edition of *businessline's* Changemaker Awards today

HONOURING HEROES. Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman will give away the awards at an event in New Delhi

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The stage is set for the eighth edition of the *businessline* Changemaker Awards in New Delhi on Tuesday, September 22.

The awards, which honour the country's quiet architects of societal transformation, have locked in headline leadership.

Union Minister for Finance and Corporate Affairs Nirmala Sitharaman brings the administrative gravitas as Chief Guest, marking her third time anchoring the marquee event in seven years.

The milestone edition is presented by Sastra Deemed University and powered by City Union Bank. The associate partners are State Bank of India, Life Insurance Corporation of India, Government of Andhra Pradesh, Andhra Pradesh Industrial Infrastructure Corporation, Citizen watches, Government of Uttarakhand, Jammu & Kashmir Bank, National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development, National Thermal Power Corporation, Indian Bank, Steel Authority of India Ltd, GAIL (India) Ltd, Essar Group, ICAI Group, National Mineral Develop-



Nirmala Sitharaman, Finance Minister

ment Corporation and UCO Bank. The mobility partner is Kia Sorento.

NOMINATIONS
Over 1,600 nominations across five categories were received for the awards, starting with a public call on May 12. Simultaneously, *businessline* journalists and knowledge partners — Ashoka Foundation and Deloitte — nominated potential candidates.

The submission window closed at midnight on July 7, and all entries underwent multiple screening rounds based on the selection criteria. The awards feature five categories: Social, Digital, and Financial Transformation, alongside Young Changemaker and Iconic Changemaker. The flagship

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“Changemaker of the Year” award honours far-reaching impact.

The *businessline* editorial team and knowledge partners select the Iconic Changemaker nominees.

The award selection jury met in Chennai on August 10. Chaired by Justice (retired) Prabha Sridevan, the 2026 jury includes Suresh Narayanan, Safeena Hussain, B Santhanam, NS Nappinai, A Balasubramanian and Dr Mukund Rajan.

Seven editions of the awards have been held since

2018, the year *The Hindu businessline* stepped into its 25th year of publishing. The 2021 edition could not be held due to the pandemic.

The awards are given across six categories: Changemaker: Financial Transformation; Changemaker: Digital Transformation; Changemaker: Social Transformation, Young Changemaker, Changemaker of the Year and Iconic Changemaker.

THE PROCESS
After the nomination win-

Rapidly expanding to make India an AI hub: Microsoft

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

Global technology giant Microsoft on Monday said that it was rapidly expanding its data centres in India and they will not serve only for the country, but as an artificial intelligence (AI) hub for the world.

Microsoft also formally launched its fourth India cloud region, in Hyderabad, as part of its \$20.5 billion investment commitment to the India's digital and AI infrastructure.

CAPACITY BOOST

“We roughly have 2GW of data centre capacity in our country. By 2035, we will build 6-7X... that's already begun with \$100 billion in investments already committed... The Indian government is putting in \$1.3 billion, the government is truly catalysing the ecosystem... India is, and India will emerge as the AI infrastructure hub, for not just for India, but for Asia and the Global South,” Puneet Chandok, President, Microsoft India and South Asia said.

He said India has an advantage with the digital public infrastructure like the

UPI, Aadhaar, DigiYatra, and all of the digital public infrastructure in the country, and now was starting to do same for AI.

“India is starting to do the same for intelligence now. It's time for us to be digital public infrastructure... 45,000 GPUs (graphics processing units) from the AI Mission... 14,000 datasets, more than 300 models in AIKosh, India's shared national platform for AI datasets and models... we're innovating, we're building from classrooms to boardrooms,” Chandok noted.

Meanwhile, speaking at the event, S Krishnan, Secretary, Ministry of Electronics and IT asked Microsoft to locate future data centres closer to power generation sources rather than near cable landing stations, to cut costs for both the company and the country.

COSTS INVOLVED

“Eventually you will have to go and install capacity closer to where the power itself is generated so that we don't have to wheel it all across. It will be much more economical if you go closer to where the power itself is generating,” he said.

Coimbatore youngster's three-wheel patrol vehicle gets podium finish at top awards

Rohan Das
Chennai

At the Chennai Central Station, the usual hustle bustle of passengers is interrupted by a peculiar site. Teams of police personnel zip through the long platforms, standing on a futuristic three-wheeled electric vehicle, manoeuvring around the commuters and patrolling the station.

The vehicle, Trike 2π, is an innovation developed by S Shakeel Akthar, a mechanical engineering graduate from Coimbatore's Kumaraguru College of Technology (KCT) and has now been named a national runner-up at the prestigious James Dyson Award 2026.

RIDER BALANCE

Trike 2π has been built with a three-wheel architecture that helps the rider balance the vehicle while also enabling 360-degree turns within a five-foot radius. It has been designed as a solution that allows its riders to move quickly and efficiently along pedestrian areas where other larger vehicles are not feasible.

In an interview with *businessline*, Akthar suggested



PATROL INNOVATION. With plans to expand its deployment, the vehicle not only showcases S Shakeel Akthar's (above) ingenuity but also aims to revolutionise urban patrolling

that the idea for Trike 2π came from within the KCT campus.

“Our campus is spread across 150 acres and I often had to walk long distances between the different academic, management and administration blocks. That made me think about the security personnel who had to patrol the campus on foot for

hours multiple times a day. As a mechanical engineering student, I thought a simple mobility solution could help,” he said.

MULTIPLE TRIALS

After multiple trials with KCT's own security staff who suggested inputs ranging from a suspension system to a water-bottle holder, Trike

2π reached its final form.

The vehicle has been launched at the Chennai Central Railway Station as well as been experimented with by members of the Coimbatore police.

The three-wheel design, Akthar suggested, was intended to combine the manoeuvrability of a two-wheeler with the stability of a four-wheeler.

“We registered ourselves as a company last year and also we are getting some funding support from IIT Palakkad,” he said. “We have deployed 10 vehicles in the Chennai station and plan to assemble more to deploy across other stations,” he said.

REAL PROBLEMS

The James Dyson Award, established by the James Dyson Foundation, is an international competition that recognises student and graduate innovations in engineering and design that seek to address real-world problems.

Trike 2π will now be considered for the James Dyson Award's global Top 20 shortlist with the eventual winner awarded a cash prize of \$30,000.

Refurbished phones gain traction as new smartphone sales slow

Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai



Smartphone retailers are scrambling to find second-hand mobile vendors ahead of the festive season as customers look for alternatives amid mounting prices.

Tired of waiting out the growing component costs, many customers have started asking retailers about second-hand mobiles. The demand has reached a point where retailers at a recent Bajaj Finserv event were exchanging contact details of refurbished phone vendors to buy the products in bulk, according to Kailash Lakhyani, Founder and Chairman of the All India Mobile Retailers Association (AIMRA).

“Until last year, there was no such demand. So, vendors selling second-hand devices were few and far between. Samsung and Vivo offer refurbished products directly through their websites and service outlets, while Cashify has its own outlets across India,” said Lakhyani.

He added that sales of new smartphones in mainline stores have dropped by 30-40 per cent since Independence Day, driven by a continuous month-on-month surge in smartphone prices.

Meanwhile, the soaring demand for refurbished devices has created a supply gap in the market, prompting the Organised Retailers Association to schedule a meeting with key players such as Cashify in Chennai on September 22 to better understand this emerging trend.

When approached, Nakul Kumar, Co-founder and CMO of Cashify, said there is healthy consumer interest ahead of the festive season for refurbished smartphones, particularly in the ₹20,000-₹45,000 price range.

“Demand is increasingly

being driven by consumers seeking premium features and 5G devices at more accessible prices. New launches and festive offers also accelerate upgrade cycles. As existing users sell their devices, the secondary market benefits from better supply, wider choice, and stronger demand,” said Kumar, pointing to a market shift from an affordability-led proposition to a value-led alternative for aspirational buyers.

BUYBACKS ON RISE

Accordingly, retailers are now offering buyback programmes, purchasing old phones, refurbishing them, and reselling them. Lakhyani estimated that demand for refurbished phones could grow manifold, as brands may no longer be able to offer 5G smartphones priced below ₹20,000 amid the ongoing price surge.

While this presents a significant business opportunity, the trend is also pushing consumers who cannot afford new devices, or who want flagship specifications on a limited budget, towards refurbished models.

Counterpoint Research has also noted the growing relevance of refurbished smartphones for this year's festive season, with strong volume growth in the refurbished segment during H1 2026. Rising new smartphone prices are making premium refurbished devices more attractive to value-conscious consumers.

‘Indian founders create more value abroad’

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Indian founders who grew up in the country have created \$560 billion in company value abroad, significantly more than the \$349 billion attributed to founders of India-based unicorns.

According to a report by Prosus and Dealroom, 205 current and former unicorns outside India have founders who grew up in India, compared with 102 unicorns based in India. The US accounted for the overwhelming share of this overseas value creation, with 187 of the 205 companies, or 91 per cent, based in the country.

BEST-KNOWN

Some of the best-known examples include Zscaler, co-founded by Jay Chaudhry; Rubrik, co-founded by Bipul Sinha, Arvind Jain, Arvind Nithrakashyap and Soham Mazumdar; and Nutanix, co-founded by Dheeraj Pandey, Ajeet Singh and Mohit Aron. The cohort also includes Palo Alto Networks, Bloom Energy, Astera Labs and AI company Perplexity.

Of the 205 overseas firms, 70, together valued at \$243 billion, were built by entirely Indian founding teams. Another 135 companies, worth \$317 billion, have Indian-origin founders as part of their core founding teams.

The broader index, which includes founders born in India rather than only those who grew up here, covers 323 companies. Of these, 200 were either founded in or relocated to the US, including 178 that were started there.

“The Indian Diaspora Index measures something we have seen and experienced first-hand in India: exceptional talent density with the ambition to build at enormous scale, often by solving some of the country's most complex and consequential problems. Indian founders have the ability to turn technology, ingenuity and deep local insight into businesses that can fundamentally change how people live and work,” said Saurav Jain, Principal Investor, Prosus India.

‘IBM’s tier-2 expansion offers greater innovation opportunities’

bl.interview

Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai

With the advent of AI, technology and software companies are reassessing and considering the closure of non-metro offices in India. Going against this trend, IBM India voiced keen interest in expanding further into the urban layout of India, confident that the move will allow for better creative and development opportunities on top of a desirable work-life balance for employees.

Sandip Patel, Managing Director, IBM India & South Asia, spoke about workforce trends, data centres and the performance of its Lightwell initiative.

Edited excerpts:

IBM has expanded into tier-2 cities at a time when other technology companies are reassessing smaller

centres. What is the vision behind this expansion?

One reason is diversification of location concentration.

Today, it is important not to concentrate the nature of talent and technology work at a few locations. Then access to talent: wherever we have gone, we have found meaningful talent. Third reason is the ability to build more vibrant IT ecosystems, including business partners, also moving to these locations. In some of the first locations where we expanded, including GIFT City and Kochi, business partners we work with also opened offices there. Academia is another important part of that ecosystem. There is also an opportunity to work with governments. For example, in Lucknow, within our facilities, we have created an AI GovTech Centre of Excellence that we are working on with the Uttar Pradesh government. The fourth factor is work-life balance. These emerging technology locations offer employees a very



We are building technologies where you can achieve significantly higher output with a much smaller footprint compared with traditional systems

SANDIP PATEL
MD, IBM India & South Asia



different quality of life. You have IT parks, residential communities and employees who can often live much closer to where they work.

How do you see the job market's flip-flop on hiring software engineers and coders?

Is AI going to eliminate jobs – yes. Will it create new jobs? Yes! The real question is how we take advantage of technology not only at an individual worker level but also at a management level. At IBM, we are all encouraged to

think about how we are using AI in our day-to-day work.

You may need prompt engineering skills but can the engineers in different disciplines have the aptitude to work with these technologies or can they be skilled to do so? There is a huge backlog of software enhancements that clients want. With certain capabilities like IBM's Bob, companies can accelerate the reduction of that backlog.

Amidst the data centre boom and local

concerns, how do you advise customers when talking about infrastructure?

IBM builds data centres around the world, and we have been strong advocates for green technologies and approaches that can better manage energy consumption. If you are building a data centre, environmental considerations should absolutely be part of the planning. We also advocate the use of more efficient infrastructure. We are building technologies where you can achieve significantly higher output with a much smaller footprint compared with traditional systems. Those are areas of innovation that will continue to become important. You cannot stop the evolution of data centres but sustainability, efficiency and environmental considerations must be part of it.

Beyond the expansion into tier-2 markets, what are IBM India's other key business priorities?

Our strategy is centred on hybrid cloud, AI and delivering those capabilities with a strong sense of security.

Across those areas, there are a variety of initiatives that we will continue to drive. Lightwell is an example of a security capability that we have introduced. Our broader business strategy continues, including our software portfolio, particularly around data and AI, hybrid cloud platform and the infrastructure work in India. I don't see any change in our strategy around hybrid cloud and AI. We will continue to drive those priorities.

How have customers responded to your Lightwell vulnerability solution?

The response has been nothing short of amazing. In the US, we have several very-large banks and other organisations already signed up and at different stages of design and implementation work. In India, we have started proactively discussing the offering with customers.

TRCMPU Ltd

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Managing Director

QUICKLY.
Oyster RE commissions
10 MW solar project



Ahmedabad: Mumbai-based Oyster Renewable Energy has commissioned a 10 MW solar power project for Aster Medcity in Kerala, in partnership with Aster DM Quality Care. The project is expected to meet more than 90 per cent of the hospital's total energy requirement. The project in Kasargod district will generate about 17.7 million units of clean energy annually, the company said. **OUR BUREAU**

MMA wins AIMA's top
management award

Chennai: The Madras Management Association (MMA) on Monday said it has been conferred the All India Management Association (AIMA) Best Management Association in India Award for the year 2025-26. The award was presented by former NITI Aayog CEO Amitabh Kant. **OUR BUREAU**

Dinesh Agarwal is chief of
FADA-TN & Puducherry



Chennai: Dinesh Kumar Agarwal has been elected as the State Chairperson of the Federation of Automobile Dealers Associations (FADA) - Tamil Nadu & Puducherry for the 2026-28 term. Tamil Nadu is one of India's key automotive markets, accounting for 7.53 per cent of the country's vehicle retail sales in FY26, said a release. **OUR BUREAU**

Congress targets poll body over SIR notices to 33 lakh Delhi voters

NO CRISIS. Delhi CEO's office says system-generated notices sent to voters to correct discrepancies in data

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Owing to outrage over 33.13 lakh voters facing notices due to the ongoing Special Intensive Revision of voters list in the national capital, the Congress described it as a "Method Of Disenfranchising Indians" which, it observed, has now turned into a "Frankenstein monster".

Congress President Mallikarjun Kharge questioned the whole process and said the SIR, which started in Bihar, had now reached the doorstep of Delhi, and perhaps now the ruling powers are realising why the Congress was calling the entire process "flawed" from the beginning. "SIR is not merely a tool for the BJP to steal votes and destroy democracy, but this flawed process is a Frankenstein's monster that has now trapped its own people!" he posted on X as the news spread that prominent per-



FLAWED PROCESS. Congress President Mallikarjun Kharge called the SIR a 'Frankenstein's monster' that has now trapped its own people. **ARUN KULKARNI**

sons even from the ruling BJP dispensation got notices from the Chief Electoral Officer, Delhi.

RAISING QUESTIONS
Former Deputy prime minister LK Advani, External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar, former Vice-President Jagdeep Dhankhar and Election Commissioner SS Sandhu, Delhi CM Rekha Gupta and Lieutenant Governor of Delhi Taranjit Singh Sandhu are among the many prominent figures in the list of voters who received notices for "discrepancies" in their

details furnished under the SIR exercise.

He questioned the basis of stripping a large number of people of their right to vote and cited the example of West Bengal, where the SIR has already been completed. He stated that 93 per cent of the Bengal cases decided so far had won their appeals — meaning 1.13 lakh persons will be added back to the voters' list.

He also criticised the Election Commission for treating certain voters as VIP.

Trinamool Congress leader Saket Gokhale

wondered how Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar is listed as a voter in Delhi, as, according to him, Kumar's name was not found in previous SIR lists for Uttar Pradesh, Kerala and Delhi — the three States he has lived and worked.

Gokhale, a former Rajya Sabha MP, wrote on X that Kumar is shown as a voter in Delhi's electoral roll, registered as Gyanesh Kumar, son of Subodh Kumar.

"If a person cannot be mapped to the last SIR in 2002/2003, they are flagged as a 'logical discrepancy' and receive a notice. So I searched for 'Gyanesh Kumar, son of Subodh Kumar' in the last SIR for these three States. Shockingly, in all three States, there is nobody registered as Gyanesh Kumar, son of Subodh Kumar in the last SIR," he claimed.

"Now, if such an entry doesn't exist in previous SIR, his current name on voter list should be flagged as a 'logical discrepancy' and he should've gotten a no-

tice," he said.

The Delhi Chief Electoral Officer's office, however, maintained that system-generated notices were being issued to voters with discrepancies to correct their data in ECINET and stressed that "there is no existential crisis as is being brought out in social and print."

CEO OFFICE
The list of voters issued notices has been uploaded on the website of the Delhi CEO, giving reasons behind every case.

Voters facing notices will get chance to defend themselves as time available for disposal of notices/claims and objections is till October 29, it said in a statement on Monday.

It also stated that special camps are being organised to ensure that no eligible voters are left out.

The first round of special camps were organised on Sunday in all the constituencies, and the next time it will take place on September 27.

NHAI seeks modification of SC order to remove strays

The Hindu Bureau
New Delhi

The National Highways Authority of India (NHAI) on Monday submitted to the Chief Justice of India that it cannot herd stray cattle and animals off public thoroughfares and find them shelter.

Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, appearing for the NHAI, told CJJ Surya Kant the responsibility to control animals and cattle loitering on highways and roads, posing a danger to drivers, lay on the respective local authorit-

ies. The NHAI said compliance would entail expenditure of around ₹7,000 crore.

ORDER ON STRAYS
Mehta said the liability for strays was laid at the NHAI's door by the Supreme Court in an order passed in November last year, directing the States and Union Territories to "forthwith" remove stray dogs from the premises of educational institutions, hospitals, sports complexes, bus stands and depots and railway stations, and relocate them "to a designated shelter" after due sterilisation



and vaccination in accordance with the Animal Birth Control (ABC) Rules, 2023.

The November 2025 order was passed by a Bench headed by Justice Vikram

Nath in *suo motu* proceedings against stray dog attacks.

The law officer requested the CJI to constitute the Bench to facilitate the NHAI to make its request for a modification of the direction.

PEGS ACCOUNTABILITY
The Bench had taken note in the order that accidents involving cattle and other stray animals on public roads and highways were all too frequent. This finding had led to the conclusion and subsequent direction that the

NHAI, along with transport and municipal authorities, should ensure the removal of cattle and other stray animals from highways.

"The Chief Secretaries of all States and Union Territories, together with the Chairperson, NHAI, shall ensure strict enforcement of these directions through appropriate administrative orders and field-level monitoring. They shall hold the concerned officers personally accountable for lapses or recurring incidents in their respective jurisdictions," the Bench had ordered.

MoD, AICPL sign ₹586-cr tank power unit deal

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The Ministry of Defence has signed a ₹586-crore contract with the Pune-based Accurate Industrial Controls Pvt Ltd to procure auxiliary power units (APUs) for T-72 and T-90 battle tanks.

The contract was inked in the presence of Defence Secretary Rajesh Kumar Singh here on Monday.

The APUs are mounted externally on the rear or side of tanks and generally generate power output of 10 to 12 kilowatts, with silent runtime capability of at least six hours. They can operate in temperatures from -50°C to 45°C.

INNOVATION
The induction of indigenously developed APUs will further strengthen the operational readiness, reliability



and sustainability of the Army's mechanised formations, the Ministry of Defence said in a statement.

The procurement is a significant step towards indigenisation of critical sub-systems of armoured platforms and demonstrates industry-led research and development (Make-II).

The Ministry said this also shows the effectiveness of the mechanism in translating indigenous innovation into production and induction.

According to the MoD, the contract marks a notable milestone towards achieving *aatmanirbharta* in defence.

MGR IFR service links Nhava Sheva, Kochi with Gulf

Our Bureau
Kochi

DP World Cochin's International Container Transshipment Terminal (ICTT) has received the MGR IFR Service, a new shipping connection linking the port directly with key destinations in the UAE, Oman and Yemen.

The service provides faster access to West Asia for businesses across southern India.

The new MGR IFR service connects Kochi and Nhava Sheva with Fujairah (UAE), Sohar (Oman) and Aden (Yemen) on a fortnightly rotation.

CONNECTIONS
The service is operated by vessels *MV Marsa Virgo*, which made the inaugural call at Kochi, and *MV Marsa Zenith*, each offering a capacity of more than 500 TEUs per voyage.

Food tech firm Arboreal Bio to invest ₹125 cr to expand capacity

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

As FMCG and nutrition companies add protein to everyday foods and seek alternatives to sugar, Lucknow-based Arboreal Bioinnovations is seeing demand run ahead of capacity.

The company is investing ₹125 crore over the next two years to expand manufacturing in Lucknow and Gujarat after FY26 revenue of ₹197 crore accelerated to a current annualised run rate of ₹455-500 crore.

The ingredient-technology company, founded in 2015 by Swati Pandey, CEO, and Manish Chauhan, COO, supplies ingredients and formulation technologies spanning sugar reduction, proteins, and other functional ingredients to food and nutrition companies. HUL's

The company has a manufacturing unit in Lucknow and a joint venture unit in Gujarat

Horlicks Protein is among products using an Arboreal ingredient. "Right now we have more demand for our ingredients than what we can produce," Chauhan said.

Arboreal recently raised ₹230 crore in funding from EAAA Alternatives, formerly Edelweiss Alternatives, Omnivore, and Rainmatter, after raising about ₹42 crore previously.

The company has separately outlined ₹50-60 crore of investment in R&D as it develops new ingredients and applications. The expansion will add to its Lucknow manufacturing base and a protein-manufacturing joint

venture in Gujarat, where Arboreal provides the technology and owns the underlying intellectual property.

Pandey and Chauhan returned to India in 2015 after spending about five years working abroad and initially built Arboreal around Stevia and natural sugar reduction.

But the founders concluded that remaining dependent on a single speciality ingredient would limit the company's scale.

NUTRITION ADDITION
Arboreal subsequently expanded into proteins, fibres and other functional ingredients, using technologies spanning extraction, encapsulation, formulation, fermentation and enzymatic hydrolysis. Pandey sees one of the larger opportunities in moving protein beyond supplements and shakes into regular Indian meals.

TN's added roof top solar subsidy to boost adoption

Rohan Das
Chennai

The Tamil Nadu government's decision to supplement the PM Surya Ghar rooftop solar scheme with a State level subsidy of up to ₹22,000 is expected to significantly bolster household solar additions.

In an official notification recently, the State government announced subsidy of ₹5,000, ₹10,000 and ₹22,000 for roof top solar systems of 1 kW, 2 kW and 3 kW, respectively. This will be in addition to the PM Surya Ghar subsidy of ₹30,000, ₹60,000 and ₹78,000.

Speaking to *businessline*, P Sivakumar, President of the Tamil Nadu Solar Energy Developers Association (TNSEDA) and CEO of Shriram Solar, felt the combined subsidies could cut as much as half the costs of installing



rooftop solar systems. "The key will be to release the funds as quickly as the Central government," he said. "It is important to build awareness and consumer confidence to encourage installations especially in tier-2 and -3 locations," he added.

Arulkumar Shanmugasundaram, CEO & Managing Director, SWELECT Energy Systems Ltd, suggested that beyond the headline subsidy amount, factors like eligibility, financing options, ease of application and disbursement speed, alongside net metering arrangements, will play a role.

Health Ministry approves biovigilance programme to track adverse drug reactions

Ankita Upadhyay
New Delhi

The Ministry of Health and Family Welfare has approved the Biovigilance Programme of India, under which the Indian Pharmacopoeia Commission (IPC) will lead the monitoring, assessment and prevention of adverse events associated with medicines and biological products used in organ and tissue transplantation, Minister of State for Health and Family Welfare Anupriya Patel said on Monday. The programme will cover biological products administered to both organ and tissue donors as well as recipients, and will strengthen India's safety-monitoring framework alongside existing pharmacovigilance and medical-



Union Minister of State Anupriya Patel releasing the 7th Edition of the National Formulary of India 2026 in New Delhi, on Monday **ANI**

device vigilance programmes, Patel said at the release of the 7th edition of the National Formulary of India (NFI).

The programme will focus on reporting, assessment, monitoring and prevention of adverse events associated with medicines and biological products used in organ and tissue transplant.

On pharmacovigilance, Patel said India has developed a strong system for collecting and analysing Adverse Drug Reaction data, with around 1,150 ADR monitoring centres currently operational across public and private hospitals and medical colleges.

The country also has around 773 medical-device

adverse-event reporting centres, she said.

PHARMACOVIGILANCE
Addressing the National Forum of India, IPC Secretary-cum-Scientific Director V Kalaiselvan said the IPC plans to extend its digital pharmacovigilance system to primary health centres and communities, providing access to mobile-based and QR-code-enabled mechanisms to report ADRs, as it seeks to widen India's safety-monitoring network beyond dedicated monitoring centres.

The commission is also exploring artificial intelligence-based approaches for pharmacovigilance and pharmacopoeial standards, even as it works to make the development of drug-quality standards more sustainable.

Keralam gold traders' body unveils 'Vision 2030' to upgrade business, seeks govt policy support

Our Bureau
Kochi

The Kerala Gold and Silver Merchants Association (KGSM) has framed a 'Vision 2030' action plan to boost the gold trade and make it more transparent and modern.

At a State Committee meeting, the association decided to organise 100 study sessions across Keralam to take the initiative forward and create greater awareness among traders and other stakeholders.

According to KGSM, ensuring the survival of small and medium-size jewellery businesses, protecting workers and artisans, and preserving traditional gold trade will be among the key objectives of 'Vision 2030'.

The association's office-



bearers said gold is not merely an ornament but also represents savings and financial security for millions of families.

They stressed the need for policies that strengthen legitimate and transparent business practices rather than weaken the gold trade sector.

TRADE ISSUES
The meeting discussed several issues affecting the gold trade, including record-high gold prices, high import du-

The association said a rational reduction in import duties could help curb illegal gold trade

ties, valuation of old gold, fake HUID numbers and hallmarking, GST and the additional costs associated with digital transactions.

K Surendran, President, and S Abdul Nazar, General Secretary of KGSM, said that a rational reduction in import duties, along with measures to encourage the recycling of domestic old gold, could strengthen legitimate trade and help curb illegal trading.

The association also demanded the withdrawal of

the increased UPI and HUID charges on transactions.

Another major demand was the call for a State-level Standard Operating Procedure for purchasing old gold to protect traders from financial losses and legal complications when they unknowingly purchase stolen gold.

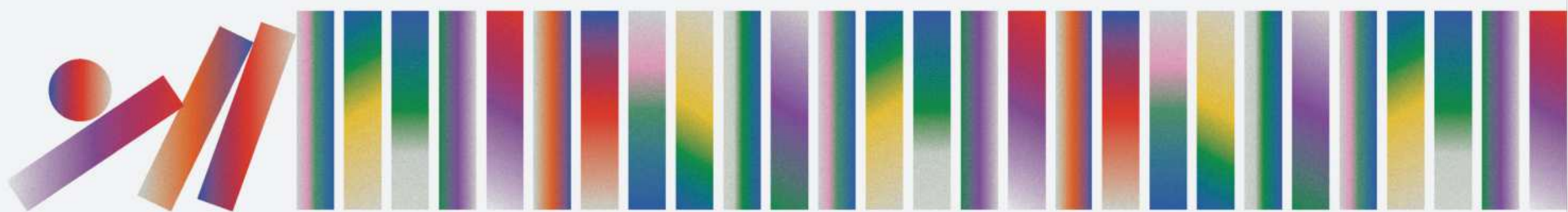
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Smt. Nirmala Sitharaman
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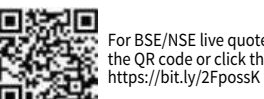
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Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52WH	52WL	PE	BSE CI	
20 Microcons [1]	208.28	220.12	208.28	227.88	207.41	561.79	321.38	130.50	13	219.45	
360 One WAM [1]	107.10	107.72	107.72	108.59	106.82	573.95	123.60	290.65	-	-	
360 One WAM [2]	107.10	107.72	107.72	108.59	106.82	573.95	123.60	290.65	-	-	
3M India [1]	349.05	347.50	339.15	340.00	338.00	444	383.00	2874.30	89	34722.30	
63 MoonSt [2]	84.75	89.025	88.83	90.50	88.45	281.65	95.72	465.55	72	89.40.00	
A											
Aadhar Hsg [1]	461.65	466.05	461.00	470.25	460.30	141.53	563.00	430.15	-	-	
Aarey Drugs [1]	102.13	102.37	103.00	103.99	100.60	206.10	103.99	50.31	-	-	
Aarti Pharma [1]	431.80	435.50	427.00	440.75	427.00	114.14	533.60	318.60	23	435.55	
Aarti Pharma [2]	431.80	435.50	427.00	440.75	427.00	114.14	533.60	318.60	23	435.55	
Aarti Pharma [3]	431.80	435.50	427.00	440.75	427.00	114.14	533.60	318.60	23	435.55	
Aavas [1]	128.64	132.10	128.50	132.30	128.50	94.86	177.94	105.20	15	132.00	
Aavas [2]	128.64	132.10	128.50	132.30	128.50	94.86	177.94	105.20	15	132.00	
AB Capital [1]	126.20	123.70	126.20	128.70	123.20	99.44	191.00	108.10	-	-	
AB Capital [2]	126.20	123.70	126.20	128.70	123.20	99.44	191.00	108.10	-	-	
AB Sun Life [1]	106.00	103.40	106.00	106.80	102.20	174.68	122.90	70.08	-	-	
ABB [1]	727.00	727.00	727.00	730.00	721.00	161.48	723.35	464.50	150	727.00	
ABB [2]	727.00	727.00	727.00	730.00	721.00	161.48	723.35	464.50	150	727.00	
ABN Newcap [1]	27.00	26.80	27.00	27.00	26.80	7.36	306.70	154.50	36	26.96	
ABN Newcap [2]	27.00	26.80	27.00	27.00	26.80	7.36	306.70	154.50	36	26.96	
ACFL [1]	50.16	49.85	50.15	50.56	49.70	235.22	38.95	48.75	-	-	
ACFL [2]	50.16	49.85	50.15	50.56	49.70	235.22	38.95	48.75	-	-	
ACME Solar [1]	435.25	458.50	430.00	464.45	437.69	691.01	46.45	195.90	-	-	
ACME Solar [2]	435.25	458.50	430.00	464.45	437.69	691.01	46.45	195.90	-	-	
Action Cons [1]	122.90	123.00	124.30	126.80	122.90	60.94	126.75	74.40	33	123.30	
Action Cons [2]	122.90	123.00	124.30	126.80	122.90	60.94	126.75	74.40	33	123.30	
Actuata Cons [1]	34.00	34.25	34.00	34.50	33.90	32.73	34.70	34.00	-	-	
Actuata Cons [2]	34.00	34.25	34.00	34.50	33.90	32.73	34.70	34.00	-	-	
Adani Ent [1]	132.00	132.00	132.00	132.00	132.00	132.00	132.00	132.00	121	129.90	
Adani Ent [2]	132.00	132.00	132.00	132.00	132.00	132.00	132.00	132.00	121	129.90	
Adani Green [1]	132.00	132.00	132.00	132.00	132.00	132.00	132.00	132.00	121	129.90	
Adani Green [2]	132.00	132.00	132.00	132.00	132.00	132.00	132.00	132.00	121	129.90	
Adani Ports [1]	182.00	187.10	179.30	179.30	176.70	231.82	189.10	129.30	149	178.80	
Adani Ports [2]	182.00	187.10	179.30	179.30	176.70	231.82	189.10	129.30	149	178.80	
Adani Ports [3]	182.00	187.10	179.30	179.30	176.70	231.82	189.10	129.30	149	178.80	
Adani T & S [1]	60.00	63.80	65.65	65.65	62.95	62.95	62.95	46.28	-	-	
Adani T & S [2]	60.00	63.80	65.65	65.65	62.95	62.95	62.95	46.28	-	-	
Adani Wilam [1]	186.98	183.56	185.60	187.05	182.70	157.72	18.90	171.19	-	-	
Adani Wilam [2]	186.98	183.56	185.60	187.05	182.70	157.72	18.90	171.19	-	-	
Adani Foods [1]	26.15	26.20	25.90	26.80	25.70	15.20	12.95	94.65	153.65	28	26.80
Adani Foods [2]	26.15	26.20	25.90	26.80	25.70	15.20	12.95	94.65	153.65	28	26.80
AdityaBirla [1]	81.77	80.89	81.50	81.52	80.60	41.13	150.79	80.60	-	-	
AdityaBirla [2]	81.77	80.89	81.50	81.52	80.60	41.13	150.79	80.60	-	-	
AdityaBirla [3]	81.77	80.89	81.50	81.52	80.60	41.13	150.79	80.60	-	-	
AdityaBirla [4]	81.77	80.89	81.50	81.52	80.60	41.13	150.79	80.60	-	-	
AdityaBirla [5]	81.77	80.89	81.50	81.52	80.60	41.13	150.79	80.60	-	-	
AdityaBirla [6]	81.77	80.89	81.50	81.52	80.60	41.13	150.79	80.60	-	-	
AdityaBirla [7]	81.77	80.89	81.50	81.52	80.60	41.13	150.79	80.60	-	-	
AdityaBirla [8]	81.77	80.89	81.50	81.52	80.60	41.13	150.79	80.60	-	-	
AdityaBirla [9]	81.77	80.89	81.50	81.52	80.60	41.13	150.79	80.60	-	-	
AdityaBirla [10]	81.77	80.89	81.50	81.52	80.60	41.13	150.79	80.60	-	-	
AdityaBirla [11]	81.77	80.89	81.50	81.52	80.60	41.13	150.79	80.60	-	-	
AdityaBirla [12]	81.77	80.89	81.50	81.52	80.60	41.13	150.79	80.60	-	-	
AdityaBirla [13]	81.77	80.89	81.50	81.52	80.60	41.13	150.79	80.60	-	-	
AdityaBirla [14]	81.77	80.89	81.50	81.52	80.60	41.13	150.79	80.60	-	-	
AdityaBirla [15]	81.77	80.89	81.50	81.52	80.60	41.13	150.79	80.60	-	-	
AdityaBirla [16]	81.77	80.89	81.50	81.52	80.60	41.13	150.79	80.60	-	-	
AdityaBirla [17]	81.77	80.89	81.50	81.52	80.60	41.13	150.79	80.60	-	-	
AdityaBirla [18]	81.77	80.89	81.50	81.52	80.60	41.13	150.79	80.60	-	-	
AdityaBirla [19]	81.77	80.89	81.50	81.52	80.60	41.13	150.79	80.60	-	-	
AdityaBirla [20]	81.77	80.89	81.50	81.52	80.60	41.13	150.79	80.60	-	-	
AdityaBirla [21]	81.77	80.89	81.50	81.52	80.60	41.13	150.79	80.60	-	-	
AdityaBirla [22]	81.77	80.89	81.50	81.52	80.60	41.13	150.79	80.60	-	-	
AdityaBirla [23]	81.77	80.89	81.50	81.52	80.60	41.13	150.79	80.60	-	-	
AdityaBirla [24]	81.77	80.89	81.50	81.52	80.60	41.13	150.79	80.60	-	-	
AdityaBirla [25]	81.77	80.89	81.50	81.52	80.60	41.13	150.79	80.60	-	-	
AdityaBirla [26]	81.77	80.89	81.50	81.52	80.60	41.13	150.79	80.60	-	-	
AdityaBirla [27]	81.77	80.89	81.50	81.52	80.60	41.13	150.79	80.60	-	-	
AdityaBirla [28]	81.77	80.89	81.50	81.52	80.60	41.13	150.79	80.60	-	-	
AdityaBirla [29]	81.77	80.89	81.50	81.52	80.60	41.13	150.79	80.60	-	-	
AdityaBirla [30]	81.77	80.89	81.50	81.52	80.60	41.13	150.79	80.60	-	-	
AdityaBirla [31]	81.77	80.89	81.50	81.52	80.60	41.13	150.79	80.60	-	-	
AdityaBirla [32]	81.77	80.89	81.50	81.52	80.60	41.13	150.79	80.60	-	-	
AdityaBirla [33]	81.77	80.89	81.50	81.52	80.60	41.13	150.79	80.60	-	-	
AdityaBirla [34]	81.77	80.89	81.50	81.52	80.60	41.13	150.79	80.60	-	-	
AdityaBirla [35]	81.77	80.89	81.50	81.52	80.60	41.13	150.79	80.60	-	-	
AdityaBirla [36]	81.77	80.89	81.50	81.52	80.60	41.13	150.79	80.60	-	-	
AdityaBirla [37]	81.77	80.89	81.50	81.52	80.60	41.13	150.79	80.60	-	-	
AdityaBirla [38]	81.77	80.89	81.50	81.52	80.60	41.13	150.79	80.60	-	-	
AdityaBirla [39]	81.77	80.89	81.50	81.52	80.60	41.13	150.79	80.60	-	-	
AdityaBirla [40]	81.77	80.89	81.50	81.52	80.60	41.13	150.79	80.60	-	-	
AdityaBirla [41]	81.77	80.89	81.50	81.52	80.60	41.13	150.79	80.60	-	-	
AdityaBirla [42]	81.77	80.89	81.50	81.52	80.60	41.13	150.79	80.60	-	-	
AdityaBirla [43]	81.77	80.89	81.50	81.52	80.60	41.13	150.79	80.60	-	-	
AdityaBirla [44]	81.77	80.89	81.50	81.52	80.60	41.13	150.79	80.60	-	-	
AdityaBirla [45]	81.77	80.89	81.50	81.52	80.60	41.13	150.79	80.60	-	-	
AdityaBirla [46]	81.77	80.89	81.50	81.52	80.60	41.13	150.79	80.60	-	-	
AdityaBirla [47]	81.77	80.89	81.50	81.52	80.60	41.13	150.79	80.60	-	-	
AdityaBirl											

